Moody's Ratings Announces Completion Of A Periodic Review Of Ratings Of Grupo Bimbo, S.A.B. De C.V.

Friday, September 25, 2026 7:09 PM ET

The following is a press release from Moody's:

Moody's Ratings Announces Completion Of A Periodic Review Of Ratings Of Grupo Bimbo, S.A.B. De C.V.

http://www.moodys.com/page/viewresearchdoc.aspx?docid=PR_530135&WT.mc_id=AM~RG93Sm9uZXNOZXdzcm9vbTIwMjRfU0JfT1JfQ1ZfUmF0aW5nX05ld3NfQWxsX0VuZw==~20260925_PR_530135

Dow Jones Newswires

September 25, 2026 19:09 ET (23:09 GMT)

Bimbo secures 150-GWh annual renewables supply from Repsol

Thursday, July 30, 2026 12:07 PM ET

By Nephele Kirong
S&P Global Energy

Repsol SA has signed 12-year virtual power purchase agreements with Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV to supply renewable electricity equivalent to 100% of the Mexican company's annual consumption across Spain, Portugal, France and Italy.

The deal, structured as nine separate VPPAs totaling about 150 gigawatt-hours per year, will draw on wind and solar capacity from Repsol assets in Spain, including the Spanish energy company's first hybrid projects, Repsol said in a July 30 statement.

"This agreement with Bimbo Group allows us to strengthen our renewable portfolio while meeting the long-term needs of large energy consumers," said João Costeira, executive managing director of low-carbon generation at Repsol.

The arrangement covers 18 Bimbo production facilities in Southern Europe and moves beyond standard renewable energy certificate purchases to long-term agreements tied directly to physical generation assets. The VPPAs support Bimbo Group's target to reach net-zero carbon emissions by 2050.

Schneider Electric SE advised on the transaction.

Repsol operates more than 6 gigawatts of installed capacity, mainly in Spain and the US.

This article was published by S&P Global Market Intelligence and not by S&P Global Ratings, which is a separately managed division of S&P Global.

Mexican Stocks Fall 0.8%

Monday, July 20, 2026 5:51 PM ET

This article was automatically generated by Dow Jones using technology from Automated Insights.

Stocks in Mexico slipped Monday, as the IPC Index dropped 0.8% to 66122.78.

Among large local companies, Gentera was the biggest laggard, falling 2.9%, followed by shares of GCC, which declined 2.5%. Shares of Grupo Aeroport Pacifico B fell 2.5%.

Sitios Latinoamerica B1 was the biggest leader during the session, gaining 3.2%, and Grupo Bimbo Series A increased 2.6%. Grupo Carso Series A1 rounded out the top three movers, as shares gained 1.8%.

U.S. stock indexes closed mixed with the Nasdaq Composite Index closing flat. Meanwhile, the S&P 500 Index declined 0.2%, and the Dow Jones Industrial Average declined 0.6%.

Data source: Dow Jones Market Data, FactSet

Dow Jones Newswires

July 20, 2026 17:51 ET (21:51 GMT)

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Mexican Stocks Fall 0.2%

Wednesday, July 15, 2026 5:51 PM ET

This article was automatically generated by Dow Jones using technology from Automated Insights.

Stocks in Mexico slipped Wednesday, as the IPC Index dropped 0.2% to 66399.71.

Among large local companies, Alsea was the biggest laggard, falling 2.8%, followed by shares of Regional Series A, which dropped 2.3%. Shares of Gentera declined 1.6%.

Banco del Bajio was the biggest leader during the session, adding 2.6%, and Grp Aero del Sureste B gained 2.1%. Grupo Bimbo Series A rounded out the top three movers, as shares increased 2.1%.

Stock indexes in the U.S. rose as the Nasdaq Composite Index increased 0.6%. Meanwhile, the S&P 500 Index added 0.4%, and the Dow Jones Industrial Average added 0.3%.

Data source: Dow Jones Market Data, FactSet

Dow Jones Newswires

July 15, 2026 17:51 ET (21:51 GMT)

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Mexican Stocks Decline 0.9%

Monday, June 22, 2026 5:51 PM ET

This article was automatically generated by Dow Jones using technology from Automated Insights.

Stocks in Mexico slipped Monday, as the IPC Index dropped 0.9% to 67125.26.

Among large local companies, Grupo Bimbo Series A was the biggest laggard, falling 4.3%, followed by shares of GCC, which dropped 4.2%. Shares of Grupo Carso Series A1 declined 4.0%.

Volaris A was the biggest leader during the session, increasing 5.0%, and Bolsa Mex de Valores A rose 3.9%. Alpek rounded out the top three movers, as shares rose 3.0%.

U.S. stock indexes ended mixed as the Dow Jones Industrial Average added 0.3%. Meanwhile, the S&P 500 Index fell 0.4%, and the Nasdaq Composite Index fell 1.3%.

Data source: Dow Jones Market Data, FactSet

Dow Jones Newswires

June 22, 2026 17:51 ET (21:51 GMT)

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Mexican Stocks Decline 0.9%

Wednesday, June 10, 2026 5:51 PM ET

This article was automatically generated by Dow Jones using technology from Automated Insights.

Stocks in Mexico slipped Wednesday, as the IPC Index declined 0.9% to 64821.61.

Among large local companies, Gentera was the biggest laggard, tumbling 5.3%, followed by shares of Industrias Penoles, which fell 3.8%. Shares of Grupo Aeroport Pacifico B fell 2.3%.

Grupo Carso Series A1 was the biggest leader during the session, increasing 4.1%, and Corporacion Moctezuma added 2.8%. Grupo Bimbo Series A rounded out the top three movers, as shares added 1.9%.

Stock indexes in the U.S. closed down as the Nasdaq Composite Index dropped 2.0%. Meanwhile, the Dow Jones Industrial Average declined 1.9%, and the S&P 500 Index dropped 1.6%.

Data source: Dow Jones Market Data, FactSet

Dow Jones Newswires

June 10, 2026 17:51 ET (21:51 GMT)

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Mexican Stocks Fall 0.7%

Monday, June 1, 2026 5:51 PM ET

This article was automatically generated by Dow Jones using technology from Automated Insights.

Stocks in Mexico slipped Monday, as the IPC Index fell 0.7% to 68137.03.

Among large local companies, Industrias Penoles was the biggest laggard, declining 4.0%, followed by shares of Grupo Carso Series A1, which declined 4.0%. Shares of Grupo Bimbo Series A dropped 3.6%.

Gentera was the biggest leader during the session, rising 3.4%, and Regional Series A rose 2.7%. Minera Frisco rounded out the top three movers, as shares gained 2.5%.

U.S. stock indexes increased as the Nasdaq Composite Index increased 0.4%. Meanwhile, the S&P 500 Index increased 0.3%, and the Dow Jones Industrial Average increased 0.1%.

Data source: Dow Jones Market Data, FactSet

Dow Jones Newswires

June 01, 2026 17:51 ET (21:51 GMT)

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Mexican Stocks Rise 0.2%

Tuesday, May 19, 2026 5:51 PM ET

This article was automatically generated by Dow Jones using technology from Automated Insights.

Stocks in Mexico rose Tuesday, as the IPC Index added 0.2% to 68555.63.

Among large local companies, Gentera was the biggest leader during the session, surging 5.0%, and Grupo Bimbo Series A surged 3.1%. Alpek rounded out the top three movers, as shares gained 2.4%.

Cydsa Series A was the biggest laggard, dropping 4.5%, followed by shares of El Puerto de Liverpool C1, which dropped 1.9%. Shares of Corp. Inmobiliaria Vesta declined 1.9%.

Stock indexes in the U.S. closed down with the Nasdaq Composite Index dropping 0.8%. Meanwhile, the S&P 500 Index declined 0.7%, and the Dow Jones Industrial Average fell 0.6%.

Data source: Dow Jones Market Data, FactSet

Dow Jones Newswires

May 19, 2026 17:51 ET (21:51 GMT)

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Mexican Stocks Decline 0.2%

Friday, May 8, 2026 5:51 PM ET

This article was automatically generated by Dow Jones using technology from Automated Insights.

Stocks in Mexico slipped Friday, as the IPC Index fell 0.2% to 69855.58.

Among large local companies, Alpek was the biggest laggard, dropping 3.9%, followed by shares of Grupo Bimbo Series A, which dropped 2.9%. Shares of Organizacion Soriana B declined 2.3%.

Becle was the biggest leader during the session, gaining 1.8%, and El Puerto de Liverpool C1 rose 1.8%. GCC rounded out the top three movers, as shares rose 1.3%.

U.S. stock indexes finished mixed as the Nasdaq Composite Index increased 1.7%. Meanwhile, the S&P 500 Index gained 0.8%, and the Dow Jones Industrial Average was flat.

Data source: Dow Jones Market Data, FactSet

Dow Jones Newswires

May 08, 2026 17:51 ET (21:51 GMT)

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Top News Today/Canada: Sherritt Shares Down After Suspending Cuban Venture Activites

Thursday, May 7, 2026 4:31 PM ET

HEADLINES

Sherritt International Halts Venture Activities in Cuba Under U.S. Sanction Threat

Canadian miner Sherritt International suspended its joint-venture activities in Cuba and directors including Chair Brian Imrie resigned after President Trump ramped up efforts to force regime change on the island.

The stock plummeted 42% to settle at C$0.14.

Sherritt said Thursday it has suspended direct participation in venture activities in Cuba, effective immediately, and that it is taking steps to repatriate its employees. The company said it has requested partners send expatriate personnel to Canada.

Brian Imrie, Richard Moat and Brett Richards have resigned from the company's board. Imrie was named independent chair effective late November.

The moves come after the Trump administration at the start of the month issued an executive order expanding sanctions against Cuba.

BCE Reveals Bell Business Markets for First Time as AI Demand Boosts Revenue

BCE disclosed revenue from its Bell Business Markets division for the first time, showing the enterprise unit helped lift first-quarter revenue on the back of strong demand for its new artificial-intelligence-powered platforms.

With fiber rollouts slowing and wireless competition intensifying in Canada's communications space, BCE is leaning into higher-margin digital services and cross-border expansion to reshape its growth profile.

Bell Business Markets, which houses the company's AI-powered enterprise platforms, saw revenue rise 9.7% in the quarter, driven by a more-than-doubled jump in sales from its AI-products Ateko, Bell Cyber and Bell AI Fabric.

CEO Says Current AI Revenue Targets Could be Light Company Turns to U.S. For Expansion

MDA Space Balance Sheet Boosted by U.S. IPO as Defense Demand Fuels Satellite Growth

MDA Space strengthened its cash position following its U.S. initial public offering, giving the company added capacity to accelerate investment in next-generation space and defence programs.

MDA Space--which develops satellites, robotics and geointelligence systems for commercial and government space programs--completed a high-profile $300 million U.S. initial public offering in March, bringing its net cash position of C$299.3 million at quarter's end.

The company has been drawing increased attention as rising global defence spending has been fueling demand for space-based surveillance and communications, bolstering its satellite and space-infrastructure business.

Company Sees Years of Growth as Space Economy Lifts Off

Canada Provides Ford With $350 Million For Pick-Up Truck Production at Ontario Plant

Canada is providing Ford Motor with nearly $350 million to refurbish the automaker's factory in suburban Toronto to accommodate the annual production of 100,000 super-duty trucks.

The financing is disclosed on a Canadian government database tracking grants and contributions, and indicates an agreement was reached in late March. Government documents indicate the money will help create about 1,800 jobs, "while complementing ongoing production at other Ford facilities" in the country.

The additional cash comes as hefty U.S. tariffs squeeze Canada's manufacturing sector, putting at risk thousands of auto-assembly and auto-parts production jobs. Vehicles assembled in Canada face a 25% levy when entering the U.S., and officials in Ottawa have tried--but with no success--to seek some relief from those auto tariffs.

Canadian Natural Resources Quarterly Earnings Fall

Canadian Natural Resources' earnings fell in the first quarter as the Canadian energy company lifted production volumes but saw lower prices for oil and natural has liquids.

Canadian Natural, which has a portfolio of assets in North America, the U.K. North Sea and offshore Africa, recorded net earnings of C$1.35 billion, or C$0.64 a share, against C$2.46 billion, or C$1.17, a year earlier.

The result was held back by non-operating losses of C$1.1 billion related to items including the effects of share-based compensation, risk management activities, fluctuations in foreign exchange rates and realized foreign exchange on financing activities.

Linamar Shares Climb as Revenue Rises, Tariff Exposure Proves Limited

Shares of Linamar rose after the Canadian auto-parts maker delivered a first-quarter beat and downplayed tariff risks, buoyed by fresh business wins.

Shares rose 5.1% to C$95.31.

Linamar, which makes automotive parts, industrial equipment and agricultural machinery, reported revenue that rose over 16% to C$2.94 billion, topping Wall Street forecasts of a rise to C$2.8 billion.

The beat comes as Canada's auto-parts manufacturers like Linamar have been bracing for potential cost pressures from U.S. tariff actions, particularly under Section 232 rules that target imported metals and certain industrial goods. While most of the company's output qualifies as USMCA-compliant, and therefore tariff-free, the industry has been on alert.

B2Gold Shares Rise as First-Quarter Tops Views, Lifted by Canada, Mali, Philippines Operations

B2Gold shares climbed Thursday after the company beat expectations on the back of new output from its Canadian mine, stronger revenue from Mali and the Philippines, and higher gold prices.

In Toronto, shares settled 11% higher at C$6.76.

The Vancouver, British Columbia-based gold miner late Wednesday reported revenue of $1.16 billion, up more than double from $532.1 million a year earlier.

The cost of gold has surged throughout the year, making gold mining more lucrative. The company was able to sell its gold at an average price of $4,193 an ounce in the quarter, up from $2,892 an ounce a year ago.

Endeavour Silver Rises as Profit Lifted by Higher Gold, Silver Output, Revenue Growth

Endeavour Silver shares surged after the company reported strong first-quarter revenue growth on the back of higher production and precious metal prices.

The stock rose nearly 9% to C$13.82.

The Vancouver, British Columbia-based miner late on Wednesday reported consolidated production of 1.88 million ounces silver and 11,740 ounces of gold. On a silver-equivalent basis, total production was of 3.3 million ounces, 78% higher than the same period in 2025.

The higher production supported a more than tripled rise in revenue, which came to $209.7 million, up from $63.5 million a year earlier.

Maple Leaf Foods Profit Down on Pork Spin-Off, Poultry Drives Revenue Higher

Maple Leaf Foods' first-quarter profit fell after losing contributions from its spun-off pork business, though stronger poultry sales helped lift revenue.

The Canadian packaged-foods and protein company posted on Thursday a lower net income of C$46.1 million, or C$0.37 a share, down from C$49.6 million, or C$0.40 a share, in the comparable quarter a year ago.

The decline came mainly because the company no longer benefits from the profits of the pork business it sold, while higher earnings from the remaining operations helped soften the drop.

Premium Brands Holdings Profit Rises, Revenue Lifted by U.S. Business

Premium Brands Holdings profit rose in the first quarter, fueled by strong U.S. performance that helped drive revenue higher.

The Canadian specialty food company on Thursday posted net income of C$2.9 million, up from C$2.6 million in the comparable quarter a year ago. On a per-share basis, earnings were unchanged at C$0.06.

Adjusted earnings were C$0.83 a share, coming ahead of analyst forecasts of C$0.73 a share, according to FactSet.

Revenue rose over 24% to C$2.05 billion, just shy of C$2.06 billion expected by analysts.

TALKING POINT

Mexico Brings Major Trade Mission to Canada as USMCA Review Approaches

By Meera Raman of The Globe and Mail

A major Mexican trade mission kicked off Thursday in Toronto as both countries look to deepen business ties ahead of the review of the North American free-trade pact -- one that's seen the two countries take differing strategies in talks with the United States.

The mission is Mexico's largest to Canada in recent memory, bringing more than 240 companies to Toronto and Montreal over two days for more than 1,800 business-to-business meetings.

Mexico's Secretary of Economy, Marcelo Ebrard, plans to meet with executives from major companies, including Air Canada AC-T, Bombardier BBD-B-T, Brookfield BN-T, CN Rail CNR-T, among others. He is also slated to lead meetings between Mexican companies and investment funds, including the Ontario Teachers' Pension Plan, one of the largest pension funds in the world.

The visit comes at a delicate moment for North American trade relations. The Canada-United States-Mexico Agreement, known variously as CUSMA or the USMCA, is up for review this year, and there are concerns that U.S. President Donald Trump could walk away from the trilateral deal.

"We can make North America the most competitive, dynamic and resilient region in the world," said Dominic LeBlanc, Canada's Minister responsible for Canada-U.S. trade, during the opening speech on Thursday in Toronto.

"The Canada-Mexico relationship is bonded by common values, by economic ambitions that have generated very considerable prosperity for both our countries over decades."

He said Ottawa is preparing for a "robust and joint review" of USMCA with both Mexico and the United States.

"This collaboration offers enormous opportunities," Mr. LeBlanc said. "Not only to reaffirm the benefits of this trilateral agreement for all three countries, but to build on its foundations and ensure that it responds to the realities of today and the global challenges of the coming years."

He said Canada and Mexico are "stable trading partners" and pointed to efforts by both governments to expand business ties under a Canada-Mexico action plan announced earlier this year by Prime Minister Mark Carney and Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum.

Mr. Ebrard said the mission is part of a longer-term strategy to deepen ties between the two countries. "We are looking for new opportunities. We want to work very closely with Canada, not just in this year, but the next 10, 20 or 50 years," he said on Thursday.

Mr. Ebrard said Mexico is seeking to strengthen ties with countries that share "similar values and similar economic institutions" at a time when the global economy is rapidly shifting.

Canada and Mexico have publicly emphasized co-operation ahead of the talks, portraying themselves as reliable partners. But behind the scenes, the two countries appear to be taking different approaches to Washington.

Mexico has been engaging more with the Trump administration and has signalled a willingness to move quickly on issues, while Canada has taken a more cautious approach.

The trade mission also highlighted the degree to which Canadian and Mexican supply chains have become intertwined over decades of free trade.

Fernando Lerdo de Tejada, deputy chief executive officer of Mexican baking giant Grupo Bimbo, said the company has invested more than $1.6-billion in Canada since 2014 and now operates 17 bakeries across seven provinces, employing more than 4,000 people directly.

The company plans to invest another $200-million in Canada through 2028, he said Thursday.

"This is what effective trade relationships look like in practice," he said. "The economic and productive relationship between Canada and Mexico is naturally complementary."

Mexico is Canada's third-biggest source of imports, having sent $47-billion worth of goods to Canada in 2024, led by automobiles and parts, electronics and consumer products.

But Canadian exports to Mexico have been underwhelming. Canadian companies shipped around $8.6-billion of goods to the country in 2024. Exports to the U.S., by comparison, totalled around $600-billion that year, while exports to China were around $30-billion.

Scott Thomson, chief executive officer and president of Scotiabank BNS-T, said Mexico is one of the bank's most important markets, representing approximately 10 per cent of the bank's overall earnings.

"The question now is whether we treat that advantage as a given, or whether we strengthen it deliberately," Mr. Thomson said.

Scotiabank is the only Canadian bank in Mexico and is now the fourth-largest bank in the country.

"North America is one of the most trusted places in the world to do business, and it's a platform we should use boldly," he said.

Expected Major Events for Friday

00:30/JPN: Apr Japan Services PMI

06:00/JPN: Mar Revised Machine Tool Orders

06:00/GER: Mar Foreign Trade

06:00/UK: Apr Halifax House Price Index

06:00/GER: Mar Industrial Production Index

12:30/US: Apr U.S. Employment Report

12:30/CAN: Apr Labour Force Survey

13:00/RUS: Weekly International Reserves

14:00/US: Mar Monthly Wholesale Trade

14:00/US: May University of Michigan Survey of Consumers - preliminary

All times in GMT. Powered by Onclusive and Dow Jones.

Expected Earnings for Friday

1stdibscom Inc (DIBS) is expected to report for 1Q.

AMC Global Media (AMCX) is expected to report $-0.02 for 1Q.

ANI Pharmaceuticals Inc (ANIP) is expected to report $0.51 for 1Q.

AdvanSix Inc (ASIX) is expected to report $-0.57 for 1Q.

Airsculpt Technologies Inc (AIRS) is expected to report $-0.03 for 1Q.

Algonquin Power & Utilities Corp (AQN,AQN.T) is expected to report $0.12 for 1Q.

Alpha Metallurgical Resources Inc (AMR) is expected to report $-0.03 for 1Q.

Arbor Realty Trust Inc (ABR) is expected to report $0.03 for 1Q.

Array Digital Infrastructure Inc (AD) is expected to report $0.91 for 1Q.

Brookfield Asset Management Ltd (BAM.T) is expected to report $0.46 for 1Q.

Brookfield Business Corp (BBUC) is expected to report for 1Q.

Construction Partners Inc (ROAD) is expected to report $-0.03 for 2Q.

Dauch Corp (DCH) is expected to report $-0.18 for 1Q.

Dixie Group Inc (DXYN) is expected to report for 1Q.

Docebo Inc (DCBO.T) is expected to report $0.26 for 1Q.

EchoStar Corp (SATS) is expected to report $-0.71 for 1Q.

Emera Inc (EMA.T) is expected to report $1.18 for 1Q.

Enbridge Inc (ENB,ENB.T) is expected to report $0.96 for 1Q.

Fidelity National Information Services Inc (FIS) is expected to report $0.61 for 1Q.

Fiera Capital Corp (FSZ.T) is expected to report $0.09 for 1Q.

Fluor Corp (FLR) is expected to report $0.61 for 1Q.

Global Partners LP (GLP) is expected to report $0.33 for 1Q.

Interface Inc (TILE) is expected to report $0.33 for 1Q.

Johnson Outdoors Inc - Class A (JOUT) is expected to report $0.87 for 2Q.

Koppers Holdings Inc (KOP) is expected to report $0.50 for 1Q.

Madison Square Garden Sports Corp (MSGS) is expected to report $0.56 for 3Q.

McCoy Global Inc (MCB.T) is expected to report for 1Q.

Oshkosh Corp (OSK) is expected to report $0.95 for 1Q.

PMV Pharmaceuticals Inc (PMVP) is expected to report $-0.41 for 1Q.

PPL Corp (PPL) is expected to report $0.59 for 1Q.

Plains All American Pipeline LP (PAA) is expected to report $0.46 for 1Q.

Plains GP Holdings LP (PAGP) is expected to report $0.46 for 1Q.

Starwood Property Trust Inc (STWD) is expected to report $0.26 for 1Q.

Sylvamo Corp (SLVM) is expected to report $-0.26 for 1Q.

TELUS Corp (T.T,TU) is expected to report $0.10 for 1Q.

Telephone & Data Systems Inc (TDS,TDSS) is expected to report $-0.44 for 1Q.

The Wendy's Company (WEN) is expected to report $0.09 for 1Q.

Treace Medical Concepts Inc (TMCI) is expected to report $-0.31 for 1Q.

Ultralife Corp (ULBI) is expected to report for 1Q.

iBio Inc (IBIO) is expected to report for 3Q.

Powered by Factset and Dow Jones.

We offer an enhanced version of this briefing that is optimized for viewing on mobile devices and sent directly to your email inbox. If you would like to sign up, please go to https://newsplus.wsj.com/subscriptions.

This article is a text version of a Wall Street Journal newsletter published earlier today.

Dow Jones Newswires

May 07, 2026 16:31 ET (20:31 GMT)

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Mexican Stocks Rise 1.1%

Thursday, April 30, 2026 5:51 PM ET

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Stocks in Mexico gained Thursday, as the IPC Index added 1.1% to 67858.09.

Among large local companies, Grupo Bimbo Series A was the biggest leader during the session, jumping 9.1%, and Regional Series A surged 4.0%. Corp Interamer de Ent B rounded out the top three movers, as shares added 3.8%.

Minera Frisco was the biggest laggard, falling 4.1%, followed by shares of Becle, which dropped 1.5%. Shares of Grupo Carso Series A1 fell 1.4%.

Stock indexes in the U.S. climbed with the Dow Jones Industrial Average gaining 1.6%. Meanwhile, the S&P 500 Index rose 1.0%, and the Nasdaq Composite Index rose 0.9%.

Data source: Dow Jones Market Data, FactSet

Dow Jones Newswires

April 30, 2026 17:51 ET (21:51 GMT)

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Mexican Stocks Hold Steady

Wednesday, April 22, 2026 5:51 PM ET

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Stocks in Mexico were flat Wednesday, as the IPC Index held steady at 68836.92.

Among large local companies, Grupo Aeroport Pacifico B was the biggest leader during the session, gaining 2.4%, and Industrias Penoles increased 2.1%. Grupo Carso Series A1 rounded out the top three movers, as shares increased 1.7%.

Organizacion Soriana B was the biggest laggard, dropping 3.7%, followed by shares of Grupo Bimbo Series A, which declined 3.0%. Shares of Grupo Aeromexico declined 2.2%.

Stock indexes in the U.S. climbed as the Nasdaq Composite Index increased 1.6%. Meanwhile, the S&P 500 Index increased 1.0%, and the Dow Jones Industrial Average gained 0.7%.

Data source: Dow Jones Market Data, FactSet

Dow Jones Newswires

April 22, 2026 17:51 ET (21:51 GMT)

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Press Release: Bimbo Bakeries USA Announces Relocation of Corporate Headquarters to Dallas

Wednesday, April 22, 2026 12:36 PM ET

DALLAS, April 22, 2026 (GLOBE NEWSWIRE) -- Bimbo Bakeries USA, Inc. (Bimbo USA) announced today the strategic decision to relocate its corporate headquarters from Horsham, Pennsylvania, to Dallas, Texas. The move strengthens alignment across U.S. operations and supports the company's long-term growth strategy.

As the largest baking company in the country, Bimbo USA benefits from Dallas' central location and closer proximity to Grupo Bimbo's global corporate office in Mexico City, strengthening collaboration and enabling faster, more integrated decision-making across operations.

Dallas is also a significant market for the company, with multiple bakeries, sales centers and distribution facilities already established across the Dallas-Fort Worth area. The region offers a strong business environment, access to a diverse talent pool and infrastructure that supports Bimbo USA's future. Relocating the headquarters further aligns leadership with a region that already supports key parts of the company's operations.

"Our commitment to baking and delivering the highest-quality, nutritious and delicious baked goods and snacks to our customers remains our top priority," said Greg Koehrsen, President. "Relocating our headquarters to Dallas positions us to operate more efficiently as we continue to invest in our brands and our communities."

Bimbo USA's senior leadership team and many other positions are already working in the new headquarters, located at 5525 MacArthur Blvd., Irving, Texas, and the company will continue to recruit for additional corporate roles at this location.

Bimbo USA's history in Texas began in 1998, when Grupo Bimbo entered the U.S. market through the acquisition of Mrs. Baird's Bakery. Today, the company operates multiple bakeries, sales centers and distribution centers throughout the Dallas-Fort Worth area and across Texas.

"Texas was our first home and played a defining role in our early history. We've built a strong presence here over the years, and this region remains central to who we are today. We're looking forward to deepening those roots as we grow and continuing to support the communities that have supported us," said Koehrsen.

Bimbo USA is building partnerships in the Dallas business community and strengthening relationships with local universities to support early-career recruiting. While the headquarters is relocating, Bimbo USA's commitment to the greater Philadelphia region remains strong, and the company will maintain a presence through its Conshohocken Sales Center and regional operations.

"We are deeply grateful to the greater Philadelphia community. The Philadelphia area was our home for 17 years, and we will always appreciate the important role it has played in our journey," said Koehrsen.

Customers and consumers can count on the same freshness, quality, and reliable service they enjoy every day as Bimbo USA builds on its strong foundation and enters an exciting new chapter of growth across the United States.

About Bimbo Bakeries USA

Bimbo Bakeries USA is a leader in the baking industry, known for its category leading brands, innovative products, freshness and quality. Our team of 20,000+ U.S. associates operate more than 50 manufacturing locations in the United States. Over 12,500 distribution routes deliver our leading brands such as Arnold, Artesano, Ball Park, Bimbo, Boboli, Brownberry, Entenmann's, Little Bites, Marinela, Mrs Baird's, Oroweat, Sara Lee, Stroehmannand Thomas'. Bimbo Bakeries USA is owned by Mexico's Grupo Bimbo, S.A.B de C.V., the world's largest baking company with operations in 39 countries.

Media ContactNina NegrinBuchanan Public Relationsbbu@buchananpr.com

Primary Logo

Dow Jones Newswires

April 22, 2026 12:36 ET (16:36 GMT)

*Bimbo Bakeries USA Announces Relocation of Corporate Headquarters to Dallas From Horsham, Pa.

Wednesday, April 22, 2026 12:37 PM ET

Dow Jones Newswires

April 22, 2026 12:37 ET (16:37 GMT)

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Mexican Stocks Climb 0.1%

Thursday, April 9, 2026 5:51 PM ET

This article was automatically generated by Dow Jones using technology from Automated Insights.

Stocks in Mexico rose Thursday, as the IPC Index gained 0.1% to 70314.19.

Among large local companies, Industrias Penoles was the biggest leader during the session, jumping 7.6%, and Grupo Carso Series A1 surged 4.0%. America Movil Series B rounded out the top three movers, as shares added 2.9%.

Esentia Energy Devt was the biggest laggard, declining 4.3%, followed by shares of Minera Frisco, which dropped 3.1%. Shares of Grupo Bimbo Series A fell 2.9%.

U.S. stock indexes increased with the Nasdaq Composite Index increasing 0.8%. Meanwhile, the S&P 500 Index gained 0.6%, and the Dow Jones Industrial Average added 0.6%.

Data source: Dow Jones Market Data, FactSet

Dow Jones Newswires

April 09, 2026 17:51 ET (21:51 GMT)

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Canada welcomes Trump tariffs as unconstitutional, while Mexico maintains cautious stance

Friday, February 20, 2026 4:42 PM ET

[New York - Megumi Ohara, Mexico City - Tomohiro Ichihara] Canada and Mexico, which have been affected by the tariffs, have each responded to the Supreme Court of the United States' ruling that Trump's tariffs are unconstitutional. On February 20, Canada-U.S. Trade Minister Dominic LeBlanc welcomed the Supreme Court's ruling, saying, "This supports Canada's argument that the International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA) tariffs are unjust." With the review of the United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement (USMCA) scheduled for July, North American trade relations are entering a new phase. U.S. President Trump used this law to impose tariffs of 35% and 25%, respectively, on Canada and Mexico, accusing them of being responsible for the influx of the synthetic drug fentanyl and illegal immigration into the United States. Canadian Prime Minister Carney has argued that only 1% of fentanyl entering the United States comes through Canada, and expressed disappointment over the tariffs. Tariffs under Section 232 of the Trade Expansion Act, which target steel, aluminum, and automobiles, are not affected by this ruling and will remain in place. Canada-U.S. Trade Minister LeBlanc emphasized that "we will continue to provide support to businesses and workers affected by the Section 232 tariffs." Mexico takes a cautious stance Mexican Economy Minister Ebrard, who negotiated the Trump tariffs for the Mexican government, said on February 20, "We must act carefully first." Trump has already stated that he will impose tariffs as an alternative. Ebrard emphasized the benefits of the USMCA, saying, "Mexico exports 85% of its products tariff-free." Mexican President Sheinbaum has repeatedly criticized the Trump administration's tariff policies, saying, "We need cooperation, not threats" However, for nearly a year, he has refrained from imposing retaliatory tariffs on the United States, as initially considered. One reason for this is that the actual tariff rates have been kept lower than expected. Among major Mexican companies, Grupo Bimbo, a major food company known for its low-priced "Bimbo's Bread," has filed a lawsuit with its U.S. subsidiary in the U.S. Court of International Trade, seeking the return of tariffs it has paid by 2025. The company's lawsuit argues that the IEEPA tariffs violate the Constitution because they were imposed by executive order, not by the legislature. The Trump administration has implemented preferential treatment for USMCA-compliant products, such as a 25% fentanyl tariff and sector-specific automobile tariffs, by deferring tax on those products and imposing taxes based on the percentage of US-made parts. In Mexico, a number of products have been certified as USMCA compliant, and some estimates suggest the effective tax rate on Mexican products is around 10%.

Mexico's Grupo Bimbo Appoints Alejandro Rodriguez Bas as CEO

Thursday, November 6, 2025 6:35 PM ET

By Anthony Harrup

MEXICO CITY--Mexican baking and snacks company Grupo Bimbo named Alejandro Rodriguez Bas as chief executive, replacing Rafael Pamias Romero who the company said resigned to address personal and health matters.

Rodriguez Bas, an industrial engineer with a master's in business administration from Harvard, joined Bimbo in 2021 and is currently president of the Barcel Global snacks unit. He worked 10 years at PepsiCo, where he was CEO for the Australia and New Zealand region and also chief executive of Mexican dairy company Grupo Lala.

Rodriguez Bas has "solid commercial and operational experience, and a proven track record of driving growth in iconic consumer brands," Bimbo's executive chairman Daniel Servitje said in a release. Pamias Romero worked at Bimbo for eight years, including the past year and a half as chief executive.

Grupo Bimbo is the world's largest baking company with annual sales of more than $21 billion, operations in 39 countries, and presence in 52 others through strategic partnerships.

Write to Anthony Harrup at anthony.harrup@wsj.com

(END) Dow Jones Newswires

November 06, 2025 18:35 ET (23:35 GMT)

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Moody's Ratings Announces Completion Of A Periodic Review Of Ratings Of Grupo Bimbo, S.A.B. De C.V.

Tuesday, October 21, 2025 4:22 PM ET

The following is a press release from Moody's:

Moody's Ratings Announces Completion Of A Periodic Review Of Ratings Of Grupo Bimbo, S.A.B. De C.V.

http://www.moodys.com/page/viewresearchdoc.aspx?docid=PR_514327&WT.mc_id=AM~RG93Sm9uZXNOZXdzcm9vbTIwMjRfU0JfTlJfQ1ZfUmF0aW5nX05ld3NfQWxsX0ViZw==~20251021_PR_514327

(END) Dow Jones Newswires

October 21, 2025 16:22 ET (20:22 GMT)

Microsoft Invests 190 billion in AI in Mexico

Tuesday, September 24, 2024 7:10 PM ET

[Mexico City - Tomohiro Ichihara] On September 24, Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella revealed plans to invest $1.3 billion (about 19 billion yen) in the artificial intelligence (AI) business in Mexico over the next three years. It will invest extensively in infrastructure expansion and human resources development, and aim to spread advanced technologies such as generative AI. Speaking in the capital city of Mexico City, Satya Nadella said, "Double Mexico's Cloud Services and AI Capabilities", and emphasized Mexico as one of the most important markets in Latin America. In addition to expanding its data center in the state of Queretaro, near the capital, the company plans to train 5 million people over three years to help them adopt advanced AI technology. Microsoft used examples of successful Mexican global companies that have successfully implemented AI, such as Grupo Bimbo and Cemex, to improve productivity in production, sales, and supply chain as well as employee training. The person emphasized that the diffusion of advanced AI will contribute to raising the competitiveness of more SMEs through the use of AI platforms for SMEs, among others. Former Foreign Minister Ebrard, who has been unofficially confirmed as the economy minister of the new Sheinbaum government to be formed in October, welcomed the large investment by posting on X (formerly Twitter), "Microsoft's collaboration with Mexico will continue for another six years, extending into 2038." As Mexico enters 2024, there has been a series of major investment announcements in the digital sector as well as in the mainstay automotive industry. In February, the U.S.-based Amazon Web Services (AWS) also announced that it would invest more than $5 billion in Mexico over the next 15 years. [Related Articles] • • • • •

Bimbo Canada signs 2 power purchase agreements for wind, solar resources

Tuesday, April 13, 2021 3:47 PM ET

By Stephen Cedric Jumchai
S&P Global Energy

Bimbo Canada, a subsidiary of bakery-products maker Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV, entered into two 15-year virtual power purchase agreements with Renewable Energy Systems Holdings Ltd. to procure approximately 50 MW to offset its electricity consumption in Canada.

The procured power will offset the electricity consumption of Bimbo Canada's 16 bakeries, 14 distribution centers and 191 depots across the country, the company said in an April 13 news release.

The agreements will support the commercial development of two renewable energy projects in southern Alberta composed of wind and solar resources with a total installed capacity of 170 MW. Commercial development for the projects is expected to be finalized by the end of the year by RES Canada Inc., and they are scheduled to be fully operational by December 2022, the release added.

The agreements move the company closer to its goal of 100% renewable electricity by 2025, Grupo Bimbo global CEO Daniel Servitje said in the release.

Mexico-headquartered Grupo Bimbo has a virtual power purchase agreement for 100 MW from a Texas wind farm to support its U.S. operations.

This article was published by S&P Global Market Intelligence and not by S&P Global Ratings, which is a separately managed division of S&P Global.

Blue Horizon closes €183M vegan-focused VC fund – Bloomberg

Tuesday, January 19, 2021 9:00 AM ET

By Pam Rosacia
Market Intelligence

Zurich-based venture capital firm Blue Horizon Corp. raised €183 million for its vegan-focused fund at final close, surpassing its initial €100 million target, Bloomberg Markets reported, citing Managing Partner Michael Kleindl.

Blue Horizon Ventures attracted capital from more than 100 investors, including two pension funds, the European Investment Fund, Mexican food companies Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV and Sigma Alimentos SA de CV, Be8 Ventures Management GmbH and Givaudan SA, Kleindl reportedly said.

The fund will back startups focused on alternative proteins, smart packaging and related areas.

The firm aims to roll out a second fund with a slightly bigger target in the fourth quarter, the news outlet added, citing Kleindl.

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THE DAILY DOSE
Coca-Cola posts Q3'20 EPS beat; Unilever's underlying sales rebound in Q3

Thursday, October 22, 2020 8:20 AM ET

By Pratibha Alagh
Market Intelligence

TOP NEWS

* The Coca-Cola Co. reported a 2% year over year decrease in adjusted EPS for the third quarter ended Sept. 25 to 55 cents from 56 cents, but the figure still beat the S&P Capital IQ consensus estimate of 46 cents. The soft-drinks manufacturer also provided updates on its strategic initiatives, adding that the reorganization of the company's structure will result in layoffs and a reallocation of some staff. Coca-Cola also expects its portfolio to decrease by 50% to about 200 brands.

* The Unilever Group said it returned to underlying sales growth of 4.4% during the third quarter of 2020 as demand for hand and home hygiene products and at-home consumption of food remained elevated. However, the consumer goods company's revenue fell 2.4% year over year to €12.90 billion.

Market Intelligence Insights



➤ With US stimulus stalled, short sellers target consumer discretionary sector

Short interest ticked up to an average of 5.7% of outstanding shares in consumer discretionary stocks as concerns over a looming hit to households fueled expectations of a dip in stocks.

➤ More consumers buy electric scooters in response to COVID-19 – Niu CEO

S&P Global Market Intelligence interviewed Niu Technologies Chairman and CEO Yan Li to discuss urban mobility and the impact of the coronavirus pandemic.

➤ Why the stock market no longer represents the US economy

A new working paper from two finance professors sees the relatively limited employment by companies with highest market cap as chief reason behind disconnect between stock market and the "real" economy.

EARNINGS SPOTLIGHT

* Mexican baked goods company Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV said its net majority income for the third quarter jumped 85.4% year over year to 3.58 billion pesos from 1.93 billion pesos. Net sales grew 14.6% year over year to 85.80 billion pesos, primarily due to "outstanding" volume growth in North America and foreign exchange rate benefit.

* Chipotle Mexican Grill Inc. reported that third-quarter adjusted EPS fell 1.6% year over year to $3.76 from $3.82, but the figure still beat estimates. The burrito chain is also testing delivery menu price increases to offset higher costs related to delivery operations.

* Pernod Ricard SA posted a 6% year-over-year decline in organic sales to €2.24 billion for the first quarter of fiscal 2021, but the French spirits-maker said sales would return to growth in the second half of the fiscal year. The company also expects second-quarter results to still be "strongly impacted" by the coronavirus pandemic.

FOOD RETAIL & DISTRIBUTION

* Seven & i Holdings Co. Ltd.'s 7-Eleven Inc. unit has added ordering platforms Uber Eats, Grubhub Inc. and Instacart, which is registered as Maplebear Inc., to its U.S. delivery portfolio.

* Russian food retailer Lenta PLC posted retail sales growth of 4.6% to 102.26 billion rubles in the third quarter, with like-for-like sales increasing 3% and average ticket growth of 9.2%. Online sales soared 551% year over year to 1.31 billion rubles during the quarter.

* Food retailer Axfood AB posted EPS of 2.95 Swedish kronor in the third quarter, up from 2.50 kronor in the year-ago period, after net sales rose 5.5% year over year to 13.43 billion kronor.

BEVERAGES

* Coca-Cola HBC AG appointed Ben Almanzar as its CFO, effective April 1, 2021. Almanzar joins the bottler from Mars Inc. and will replace Michalis Imellos.

PACKAGED FOODS

* Animal-free dairy producer Perfect Day Inc. appointed The Walt Disney Co. Executive Chairman Robert Iger to its board of directors.

* BRF SA will halt production at its halal chicken plant in the southern part of Brazil on Nov. 16 until Dec. 5 to modernize the facility, the meatpacker confirmed to Reuters.

* Swedish fats and vegetable oils producer AAK AB said it acquired the remaining 31% stake in its Indian joint venture, AAK Kamani, from Kamani Oil Industries Pvt. Ltd. The company also reported that its third-quarter EPS rose 10% year over year to 1.69 Swedish kronor from 1.53 kronor.

RESTAURANTS

* Restaurant Brands International Inc.-owned Burger King chain has partnered with TerraCycle US Inc.'s circular packaging service, Loop, to test a new zero-waste packaging model across select outlets in the U.S. and Tokyo, beginning 2021.

MARKETS

US (futures)		Europe		Asia	
▼ S&P 500	0.15%	▲ FTSE 100	0.21%	▲ Hang Seng	0.13%
▼ Nasdaq 100	0.10%	▲ STOXX Europe 600	0.09%	▼ Nikkei 225	0.70%
▼ DJIA	0.11%	▲ Up ▼ Down – No change			

Data as of 7:30 a.m. ET, Oct. 22, 2020.
Sources: S&P Global Market Intelligence, Investing.com

Click here to read about today's financial markets, setting out the factors driving stocks, bonds and currencies around the world ahead of the New York open. Click here for a summary of indexes on the MI platform.

The Daily Dose is updated as of 8 a.m. ET. Some external links may require a subscription. Links are current as of publication time, and we are not responsible if those links are unavailable later.

Kiran Murali, Michael O'Connor contributed to this article.

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THE DAILY DOSE
JAB cuts Keurig Dr Pepper stake worth $2.2B; Impossible Foods enters Canada

Wednesday, September 9, 2020 8:15 AM ET

By Mehrose Shahzad
Market Intelligence

TOP NEWS

* Keurig Dr Pepper Inc. said its top shareholder JAB Holdings BV, which owns a 49.5% stake in the soft drinks company, will distribute 76 million shares of the company worth $2.19 billion to its minority partners, reducing its stake to 44%. Separately, the company said it will move its stock exchange listing to the Nasdaq Stock Market, effective Sept. 21.

* Impossible Foods Inc. launched its plant-based burger in Canada at some of the country's top restaurants, marking the meat substitute maker's first international debut outside of Asia. The Impossible Burger will be available in more locations throughout Canada in the upcoming weeks and will be sold in grocery stores later in 2020.

Market Intelligence Insights



➤ Sysco leads S&P 500 Consumer Staples index in August on strong Q4'20 results

The consumer staples sector rose 4.7% during the month, falling behind the wider S&P 500's gain of 7.2%, according to data compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence.

➤ New York cheered by booze imports as US port activity reaches record high

U.S. inbound port activity reached a record high in August as shipments of consumer goods surged in the wake of COVID-19. That's leading to marked congestion in areas, though not all ports have seen an improvement.

➤ China $43.8B behind in buying US goods as tensions threaten 'phase one' deal

Chinese imports of U.S. goods under the "phase one" deal were $6.33 billion in July, more than $5 billion short of the monthly purchase target under the agreement. For the year, China is $43.8 billion off the pace, according to Panjiva trade data.

EARNINGS SPOTLIGHT

* Casey's General Stores Inc. posted diluted EPS of $3.24 for the first quarter of fiscal 2021 ended July 31, up 40.3% year over year, and beating the S&P Capital IQ mean consensus estimate for normalized EPS of $2.06. The company's board also announced a dividend of 32 cents per share, payable Nov. 16.

FOOD RETAIL & DISTRIBUTION

* Swedish grocery retailer ICA Gruppen AB (publ) said August sales, excluding taxes, grew 5.4% year over year to 11.14 billion Swedish kronor. Sales in the January to August period grew 7.3% year over year.

* Workers of food delivery companies including Uber Technologies Inc.'s arm Uber Eats and Roofoods Ltd., doing business as Deliveroo, drove an unexpected surge in the number of new companies created in France in June and July, Reuters reported, citing the French commercial court data.

BEVERAGES

* Suntory Beverage & Food Ltd. said it will change commercial names of all of its European market divisions to unify the organization, effective Sept. 8. However, the legal company name of each local market will not change.

PACKAGED FOODS

* General Mills Inc. said its year-to-date at-home food demand for fiscal 2021 remained high compared to pre-pandemic levels. The company expects a strong fixed cost advantage to lead to adjusted operating profit margin expansion in the first quarter of fiscal 2021, and higher external supply chain costs to result in a decline in adjusted operating profit margin in the second quarter.

* The Unilever Group CEO Alan Jope expects the company's shareholders to support the company's plan to unify its headquarters in London and scrap its Dutch base, Reuters reported. He added that the company's North American business is growing, thanks to hygiene products and food and market share gains online.

* Bakery products maker Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV is in talks to acquire a controlling stake in packaged goods platform Everfoods from private equity firm Everstone Capital Asia Pte Ltd., *The Economic Times* (India) reported. Mexico City-based Grupo Bimbo is planning to buy the stake in Everfoods for its Modern Foods Enterprises Pvt. Ltd. bakery brand, the report said.

RESTAURANTS

* Yum! Brands Inc.-owned KFC partnered with DoorDash Inc. for on-demand delivery from 3,000 U.S. stores.

* Restaurant Brands International Inc. named Sami Siddiqui president of its Popeyes Louisiana Kitchen Inc. brand for the Americas, replacing Felipe Athayde.

* Panera Bread said it appointed Debbie Roberts executive vice president and COO of the company, effective Sept. 8.

INDUSTRY NEWS

* The U.S. will later this week announce a ban on cotton and tomato imports from China's Xinjiang region over allegations of forced labor, Reuters reported, citing a U.S. Customs and Border Protection spokesman. The ban would also apply to all products made with tomatoes and cotton, such as tomato paste and textiles and apparel.

MARKETS

US (futures)		Europe		Asia	
▲ S&P 500	0.59%	▲ FTSE 100	0.66%	▼ Hang Seng	0.63%
▲ Nasdaq 100	1.45%	▲ STOXX Europe 600	0.57%	▼ Nikkei 225	1.04%
▲ DJIA	0.36%	▲ Up ▼ Down – No change			

Data as of 7:30 a.m. ET, Sept. 9, 2020.
Sources: S&P Global Market Intelligence, Investing.com

Click here to read about today's financial markets, setting out the factors driving stocks, bonds and currencies around the world ahead of the New York open. Click here for a summary of indexes on the MI platform.

The Daily Dose is updated as of 8 a.m. ET. Some external links may require a subscription. Links are current as of publication time, and we are not responsible if those links are unavailable later.

Pratibha Alagh, Maya Balasubramanya, Mira Reyes, Isa Martinez contributed to this article.

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Grupo Bimbo in talks to acquire majority stake in Everfoods – ET

Wednesday, September 9, 2020 3:26 AM ET

By Isa Martinez
Market Intelligence

Bakery products maker Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV is in talks to acquire a controlling stake in packaged-goods business Everfoods from private equity firm Everstone Capital Asia Pte Ltd., *The Economic Times* (India) reported Sept. 8, citing two people aware of the talks.

Mexico City-based Grupo Bimbo is planning to buy the stake in Everfoods for its Modern Foods Enterprises Pvt. Ltd. bakery brand, the report said.

Everfoods acquired Modern Foods from Hindustan Unilever Ltd., the Indian arm of The Unilever Group, in 2016.

Modern Foods produces its bread and bakery goods through a network of 40 manufacturing plants and over 80,000 outlets in India, holding about 35% to 40% market share in the sector, according to *ET*.

Investment bank Investec is reportedly advising Everstone.

The newspaper said an Everstone Capital spokesperson declined to comment while Grupo Bimbo did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

Grupo Bimbo operates in 33 countries and owns over 100 brands. The company expanded into India in 2017 with the acquisition of bakery brand Harvest Gold, the report said.

As of Sept. 7, US$1 was equivalent to 73.47 Indian rupees.

This article was published by S&P Global Market Intelligence and not by S&P Global Ratings, which is a separately managed division of S&P Global.

THE DAILY DOSE
Meituan Dianping Q2'20 profit up 82%; PEs tap former retail CEOs for Asda bids

Friday, August 21, 2020 8:04 AM ET

By Pratibha Alagh
Market Intelligence

TOP NEWS

* Online food delivery company Meituan Dianping posted adjusted net profit of 2.72 billion Chinese yuan for the second quarter, up 82% year over year from 1.49 billion yuan and above the S&P Capital consensus net income estimate of 100.6 million yuan. Growth in the food delivery business boosted revenue by 8.9% year over year to 24.7 billion yuan.

* Private equity firms Apollo Global Management Inc. and Lone Star Funds have enlisted former retail executives to lead competing £6.5 billion bids for Asda Stores Ltd., Sky News reported. Apollo is reportedly working with former Debenhams PLC CEO Rob Templeman on its interest, while Lone Star is said to have tapped Paul Mason, former CEO of Asda, to spearhead its offer.

Market Intelligence Insights



➤ Diageo's $610M Aviation Gin deal a spirited bet in uneasy times

The transaction is designed to boost Diageo's revenue from the increasingly popular high-end gin category, but the COVID-19 pandemic will continue to weigh on spirits sales in the short term.

➤ Retail liquidations to become more likely as COVID-19 drags on in US

Experts say that many retailers, particularly those focused on apparel, will have a harder time staying afloat and tightening their belts as the pandemic continues.

➤ Foot traffic at US malls, outlet centers approaching pre-COVID levels

Foot traffic at malls and outlet centers is trending back toward normal levels. Tanger Factory Outlet Centers' open-air outlet centers have seen foot traffic rebound more quickly than traffic at enclosed mall REIT properties.

FOOD RETAIL & DISTRIBUTION

* San Francisco-based DoorDash Inc. rolled out on-demand grocery delivery service through its app. Customers can order from a range of more than 10,000 grocery items and get deliveries in less than an hour, the company added.

* Koninklijke Ahold Delhaize NV-owned U.S. supermarket chain Hannaford launched same-day grocery delivery through Maplebear Inc., doing business as Instacart, in the New England region, *Supermarket News* reported. This is the fourth Ahold Delhaize's U.S. supermarket brand to partner with the San Francisco-based online grocery provider, the report added.

* Delivery Hero SE CFO Emmanuel Thomassin said the delivery company has financial resources to be part of potential acquisitions, Reuters reported. "You could expect us to look at every M&A transaction in our industry," he reportedly said.

* India's Future Retail Ltd. is in talks with lenders led by State Bank of India to help fund a missed interest payment, due July 22, on its 5.6% 2025 dollar notes, Bloomberg News reported. The 30-day grace period to pay $14 million of interest expires Aug. 21.

* Massmart Holdings Ltd. said its total sales for 26 weeks ended June 28 fell 9.7% year over year to 39.6 billion South African rand. The Walmart Inc. unit also expects to post a headline loss in the range of 1.05 billion rand and 1.13 billion rand for the six months.

BEVERAGES

* PepsiCo Inc.'s North American unit, PepsiCo Beverages North America, opened a new sales and distribution center in Indianapolis, creating 30 new jobs.

PACKAGED FOODS

* Nestlé SA announced the launch of a plant-based alternative to tuna, marking its entry into the seafood alternatives market. The food and beverage company plans first to roll out the product in Switzerland under its Garden Gourmet range.

* Arcytta AG has attracted takeover interests from several buyers, including Flowers Foods Inc., Hostess Brands Inc. and Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV, *The Irish Times* reported.

* A Brazilian court ordered meatpacker JBS SA to impose a 1.5-meter distance between workers in the production line at its beef plant in the state of Mato Grosso to curb the spread of the coronavirus, Reuters reported.

* New Zealand's The a2 Milk Co. Ltd. said it made a nonbinding offer to acquire a 75.1% stake in dairy nutrition company Mataura Valley Milk Ltd. from China Animal Husbandry Group for about NZ$270 million. A2 Milk has been given a period of exclusivity to conduct due diligence for the potential deal, which would be funded with cash and settled near the end of its fiscal 2021.

* Tata Consumer Products Ltd. said profit before exceptional items and tax grew 42% year over year in the quarter ended June 30 to 4.36 billion Indian rupees from 3.08 billion rupees, driven by a 13% year-over-year increase in revenue from operations to 27.13 billion rupees.

RESTAURANTS

* McDonald's Corp. is teaming up with rapper Travis Scott as it prepares for a new marketing push aimed at younger customers, Business Insider reported, citing an internal memo by the restaurant chain's U.S. CMO Morgan Flatley.

* Taco Bell Corp. launched a new restaurant concept, Go Mobile, that introduces several digital features to the traditional drive-thru format. The first restaurant with Go Mobile will open in the first quarter of 2021. Separately, Yum China Holdings Inc. announced that it opened its first Taco Bell store in Beijing.

MARKETS

US (futures)		Europe		Asia	
▼ S&P 500	0.26%	▼ FTSE 100	0.25%	▲ Hang Seng	1.30%
▼ Nasdaq 100	0.17%	▼ STOXX Europe 600	0.03%	▲ Nikkei 225	0.17%
▼ DJIA	0.21%				

▲ Up ▼ Down – No change

Data as of 7:30 a.m. ET, Aug. 21, 2020.
Sources: S&P Global Market Intelligence, Investing.com

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Coily Lozada, Mehrose Shahzad contributed to this article.

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THE DAILY DOSE
Coca-Cola sees Q1'20 EPS impact from coronavirus; Domino's posts Q4'19 EPS beat

Friday, February 21, 2020 7:59 AM ET

By Pratibha Alagh
Market Intelligence

TOP NEWS

* Coca-Cola Co. reaffirmed its full-year 2020 guidance but said it expects a 1- to 2-cent impact on first-quarter EPS due to the new coronavirus outbreak. The beverage producer also anticipates a 1- to 2-point impact on organic revenue and an approximate 2- to 3-point impact on unit case volume in the first quarter.

* Shares of Domino's Pizza Inc. closed up more than 25% on Feb. 20 after it posted a 19.5% year-over-year increase in adjusted EPS to $3.13 in the fourth quarter of 2019 from $2.62 the year prior and above the S&P Global Market Intelligence mean consensus estimate of $2.97. The Michigan-based pizza chain also reaffirmed its two- to three-year outlook for domestic and global sales.

FOOD RETAIL & DISTRIBUTION

* Rakuten Seiyu NetSuper, a Japanese online grocery delivery joint venture between Walmart Inc.'s Seiyu GK and Japan's Rakuten Inc., recorded a 30% year-over-year increase in sales for the late October through December period, Reuters reported, citing CEO Tamae Takeda. Takeda reportedly said demand has increased further since the outbreak of the new coronavirus.

* Hong Kong-based hypermarket operator Sun Art Retail Group Ltd. posted EPS of 30 Chinese fen for 2019, up from 26 fen in 2018 and narrowly ahead of the S&P Global Market Intelligence normalized EPS estimate of 29 fen.

* Russian food retailer X5 Retail Group NV began rolling out a new store concept for its Perekrestok supermarket chain that includes more ready-to-eat and healthier products. The company plans to open more than 100 standard-size supermarkets and refurbish 30 stores under the new format in 2020.

* Food retailer Carrefour SA's Brazilian arm reported a 6.3% increase in adjusted net income to 695 million Brazilian reais during the fourth quarter of 2019 from 654 million reais in the year-ago period. Sales, excluding petrol, rose 11.4% year over year to 16.84 billion reais from 15.12 billion reais, driven by "excellent" Black Friday sales and growth across all divisions.

BEVERAGES

* Bottled water provider Cott Corp. reported adjusted EBITDA of $85.4 million in the fourth quarter of 2019, up 22% year over year from $69.8 million and ahead of the S&P Global Market Intelligence EBITDA estimate of $84.6 million. For 2020, the company expects adjusted EBITDA of $300 million to $310 million.

AGRICULTURAL PRODUCTS

* Animal feed producer C.P. Pokphand Co. Ltd. reported a net profit attributable to shareholders of the company of $345.8 million for 2019, up from $281.7 million in the previous year. The company added that the coronavirus outbreak in China has caused operational delays and that it is cautious in its outlook for 2020.

PACKAGED FOODS

* The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission cleared China Mengniu Dairy Co. Ltd.'s proposed ¥45.6 billion acquisition of Australia's Lion-Dairy & Drinks Pty. Ltd. from Kirin Holdings Co. Ltd.

* Poultry processor Pilgrim's Pride Corp. posted adjusted EPS for the fourth quarter of 2019 of 14 cents, up from 9 cents in the year-ago period but well below the S&P Global Market Intelligence normalized EPS estimate of 26 cents.

* Baked goods producer Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV reported net profit for the fourth quarter of 2019 of 1.83 billion Mexican pesos, a 27.4% year-over-year drop and below the Market Intelligence mean consensus estimate of 1.94 billion pesos, with five analysts reporting. Net profit rose 8.8% to 6.32 billion pesos for the full year. Grupo Bimbo said it will invest 2.8 billion pesos to add 4,000 electric distribution vehicles over the next four years.

* S&P Global Ratings revised its outlook for Conagra Brands Inc. to negative from stable after the packaged food company lowered its fiscal 2020 earnings guidance. The rating agency affirmed all of its credit ratings on Conagra, including BBB- long-term issuer credit rating.

* One member of the family that owns Illycaffè SpA has agreed to sell his 23% stake in the Italian coffee company to London-based private equity firm Peninsula, Reuters reported, citing sources. A source reportedly said Illy's plan to bring in a new investor is on track, while a second source added that the company is also seeking a development partner for its Polo del Gusto food group.

RESTAURANTS

* Kentucky-based casual dining chain Texas Roadhouse Inc.'s shares rose 7% in aftermarket trading after it reported that diluted EPS for the fourth quarter of 2019 grew 45.4% year over year to 61 cents from 42 cents and beat the S&P Global Market Intelligence normalized EPS estimate of 52 cents. For the three-month period, total revenue grew 19.7% to $725.2 million as comparable restaurant sales rose 4.4% at its owned stores.

INDUSTRY NEWS

* China banned imports of poultry and poultry products from Slovenia, Hungary, Germany and Ukraine due to the bird flu outbreaks, Reuters reported, citing a customs statement.

Now featured on S&P Global Market Intelligence

Food in Focus: Grocery profit margins narrow in January; bankruptcies drive M&A

Consumer producers exposed for months to coronavirus-hit Hubei

The day ahead

Early morning futures indicators pointed to a lower opening for the U.S. market.

In Asia, the Hang Seng was down 1.09% to 27,308.81, and the Nikkei 225 declined 0.39% to 23,386.74.

In Europe, around midday, the FTSE 100 decreased 0.14% to 7,426.25, and the Euronext 100 retreated 0.15 % to 1,169.30.

On the macro front

The PMI composite flash report, the existing home sales report and the Baker-Hughes Rig Count are due out today.

Click here to read about today's financial markets, setting out the factors driving stocks, bonds and currencies around the world ahead of the New York open.

The Daily Dose is updated as of 8 a.m. ET. Some external links may require a subscription. Links are current as of publication time, and we are not responsible if those links are unavailable later.

This article was published by S&P Global Market Intelligence and not by S&P Global Ratings, which is a separately managed division of S&P Global.

THE DAILY DOSE
Walmex Q4'19 EPS, net income miss estimates; Kirin's FY'19 profit drops 64% YOY

Friday, February 14, 2020 7:54 AM ET

By Pratibha Alagh
Market Intelligence

TOP NEWS

* Walmart Inc.'s Mexican arm Wal-Mart de México SAB de CV reported a 4.5% year-over-year drop in fiscal 2019 fourth-quarter net income to 11.23 billion Mexican pesos from 11.76 billion pesos a year ago. Analysts polled by S&P Global Market Intelligence had estimated Walmex's net income to reach 11.31 billion pesos. The company's EPS for the quarter came in at 64.3 centavos compared to 67.4 centavos a year ago, also missing the Market Intelligence consensus normalized EPS estimate of 65 centavos. In a statement, Walmex said 2019 was a "challenging" year due to adverse socioeconomic conditions across the region.

* Kirin Holdings Co. Ltd. posted diluted EPS of ¥67.98 for 2019, down from ¥183.53 in the prior year and missing the Market Intelligence GAAP EPS estimate of ¥71.32. Profit attributable to owners of the company slid 63.7% year over year to ¥59.64 billion from ¥164.20 billion, primarily due to a "harsh business environment" in Japan. For 2020, the maker of Kirin Lager beer expects basic EPS of ¥136.79 and attributable profit of ¥115.50 billion. Separately, the brewer rejected a proposal by a U.K.-based activist shareholder to buy treasury shares worth ¥600 billion.

FOOD RETAIL & DISTRIBUTION

* Food service company Sysco Corp. said it completed the offering of $500 million of its sustainability bonds to fund its corporate social responsibility goals through 2025.

* Supermarket chain Wegmans Food Markets Inc. expanded its partnership with Instacart to offer doorstep grocery delivery service in the New York City borough of Manhattan.

BEVERAGES

* Distiller Thai Beverage PCL posted a 13% year-over-year increase in diluted EPS for three months ended Dec. 31, 2019, to 34 Thai satang from 30 satang. Profit attributable to owners of the company rose 14% to 8.42 billion baht from 7.42 billion baht. Separately, the company said it acquired 35% shareholding interest in Myanmar-based alcoholic-drinks maker International Beverages Trading Co. Ltd. through its indirect subsidiary International Beverage Holdings (Singapore) Pte. Ltd.

* Coca-Cola Bottlers Japan Holdings Inc. swung to loss per share of ¥322.22 in 2019 from basic EPS of ¥52.68, reflecting lower sales volume, supply chain constraints and continued poor manufacturing efficiencies. The Tokyo-based company expects basic EPS of ¥50.18 in 2020.

* Japanese food and beverage company Suntory Holdings Ltd. saw profit attributable to owners of the company grow 0.6% to ¥140.94 billion in 2019. For 2020, the company expects attributable profit to decline 7.8% to ¥130 billion, as it seeks to implement a revitalization plan across its business. The company's subsidiary Suntory Beverage & Food Ltd. will undergo structural reforms in 2020 after its attributable profit fell 13.9% year over year to ¥68.89 billion in 2019.

PACKAGED FOODS

* Snacks-maker TreeHouse Foods Inc. reported adjusted diluted EPS for 2019 fourth quarter of $1.10 that met the Market Intelligence normalized EPS estimate. For 2020, the Illinois-based company expects adjusted diluted EPS of $2.40 to $2.65. Separately, the company's board confirmed the appointment of William Kelley Jr. as CFO.

* Cheerios cereal-maker General Mills Inc. said it hired Jaime Montemayor as its chief digital and technology officer, effective Feb. 24. Most recently, Montemayor was chief technology officer at convenience store chain 7-Eleven Inc.

* Danone SA launched a Track & Connect service in China for its Aptamil & Nutrilon brands for giving customers more transparency on its baby formula farm-to-fork journey. The French packaged food company plans to roll out the service in France, Germany, Australia and New Zealand later in 2020.

* Russian meat producer Cherkizovo Group reported that adjusted net profit for the fourth quarter of 2019 fell 60.7% year over year to 1.47 billion Russian rubles from 3.74 billion rubles a year ago. Meanwhile, revenue rose 10.4% to 34.49 billion rubles from 31.24 billion rubles in the year-ago period.

* Mexican baked good producer Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV's unit Bimbo QSR formed a joint venture with Food Town, McDonald's Corp.'s franchisee, in Kazakhstan. Grupo Bimbo will own a 51% stake in the combined entity, formation of which is expected to be completed during the first quarter of 2020.

* S&P Global Ratings upgraded the ratings of Tyson Foods Inc., including its issuer credit rating to BBB+ from BBB, with a stable outlook, following the successful integration of the meat processor's recent acquisitions, including those of meat supplier Keystone Foods LLC from Brazil's Marfrig Global Foods SA for $2.16 billion and BRF SA's Thai and European operations for $340 million.

* Swiss convenience-food maker Bell Food Group AG said adjusted EBIT for 2019 grew 6% year over year to CHF149.1 million from CHF140.6 million. Sales revenue declined 1.6% to CHF4.08 billion from CHF4.14 billion. The company nominated Joos Sutter and Thomas Hinderer to its board of directors.

RESTAURANTS

* Four Corners Property Trust bought two Chili's Inc. restaurant properties in Indiana from Washington Prime Group Inc. for $2.0 million.

* U.K.'s Competition and Markets Authority cleared Stonegate Pub Co. Ltd.'s acquisition of fellow pub operator Ei Group PLC for £1.27 billion. The competition watchdog added that it will not refer the merger to the second phase of investigation.

INDUSTRY NEWS

* About 300 to 400 refrigerated poultry ship containers from the U.S. to China were diverted to ports in Hong Kong, South Korea, Taiwan and Vietnam due to the coronavirus outbreak, Reuters reported, citing the USA Poultry & Egg Export Council.

Now featured on S&P Global Market Intelligence

Science plays catch-up to plant-based meat demand, investments

Kraft Heinz CEO plans to reduce new product spending headed into FY'20

PepsiCo craves smaller snack sizes, more caffeine to help drive sales

US, China putting tariff rollbacks into action as 'phase one' deal takes effect

The day ahead

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Maera Tezuka, Amanda Jean Dalugdug contributed to this article.

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DATA DISPATCH
Food in Focus: Wholesale prices slow their increase in December 2019

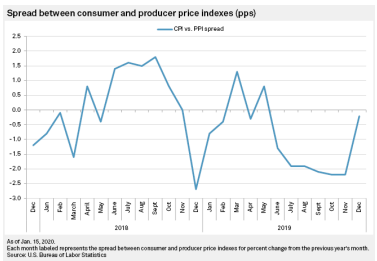
Friday, January 17, 2020 11:12 AM ET

By Alexander Bitter
Market Intelligence

Slowing wholesale price increases for fresh and dry vegetables and eggs for fresh use curbed the growth rate for producer food prices in December 2019, narrowing the spread with on-the-shelf prices.

The "final demand food" subindex of the producer price index, or PPI, rose 0.9% in December, a slower clip than November's 3.2%, according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, or BLS. The subindex is a measure of prices that retailers pay food wholesalers to stock their shelves.

The "food at home" index of the consumer price index, or CPI, rose 0.7% over the same period. The subindex represents prices paid by consumers at retailers such as Walmart Inc. and The Kroger Co., according to BLS.



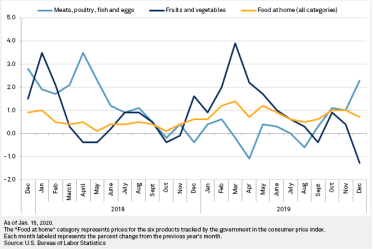
Analysts use the difference between the two metrics to determine the state of grocers' profits margins, subtracting the growth rate of the PPI subindex from the growth rate of the CPI index. When the result is negative, grocers' margins are more likely to narrow.

In December, the difference was negative by 0.2 percentage points, narrower than the 2.2% for November, according to an analysis by S&P Global Market Intelligence.

Wholesale prices for fresh fruits and melons, fresh and dry vegetables, eggs for fresh use, shortening and cooking oils, as well as beef and veal, all fell during the month. Meanwhile, prices for pork, processed turkeys, dairy products, finfish and shellfish all rose. Consumer prices for fruits and vegetables fell 1.3%, while prices rose for all other products, with cereals and bakery products advancing 0.3%, meats, poultry, fish and eggs rising 2.3%, dairy and related products notching a 2.4% gain and nonalcoholic beverages and beverage materials increasing 1%.

Other food at home, a category that includes candy and margarine, rose 0.3%.

Food at home consumer price index unadjusted YOY change (%)



As of Jan. 15, 2020.
The "Food at home" category represents prices for the six products tracked by the government in the consumer price index.
Each month labeled represents the percent change from the previous year's month.
Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics

Kroger debuted Emerge, a plant-based brand for burgers and ground meat, Jan. 8. The products are the latest in a series of plant-based meat products to be introduced by food companies and grocers.

Walmart unveiled a robot from startup Alert Innovation Inc. Jan. 8 that can pick grocery orders. The robot, called Alphabot, has been filling orders at Walmart's Salem, N.H., location, and the retailer said it will make decisions about a broader rollout of the technology after getting feedback from employees and customers.

The highest-value food deal of the month leading to Jan. 15 was Cott Corp.'s $787 million deal for filtered water provider Primo Water Corp. Cott, which has been considering alternatives for its coffee and tea business to focus on water, will assume the Primo name as part of the deal, which was announced Jan. 13.

Several major food companies found buyers for specific businesses. Conagra Brands Inc. sold its Lender's Bagels business to Bimbo Bakeries USA Inc., a subsidiary of Mexican bakery owner Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV, on Dec. 19. The companies did not disclose the terms of the deal.

Nestlé SA, meanwhile, said Dec. 19 that it would sell a majority stake of its Herta business to Spanish food company Casa Tarradellas SA for an undisclosed price. The deal, which creates a joint venture between Nestlé and Casa Tarradellas, includes cold cuts and dough.

Meat processor Tyson Foods Inc. sold California-based Golden Island Jerky Co. Inc. to Link Snacks Inc. for an undisclosed amount Dec. 30. Link makes Jack Link's beef jerky.

German conglomerate JAB Holding Co. SARL said Dec. 17 that it would combine Peet's Coffee & Tea Inc. and Jacobs Douwe Egberts BV and pursue an IPO for the new entity. Snack-maker Mondelez International Inc. is an investor in the coffee venture.

Coca-Cola Co. acquired all of milk beverage company fairlife LLC on Jan. 3 for an undisclosed amount. Coca Cola previously had a 42.5% stake in the Chicago-based business, and the soft drink giant said in a statement that the acquisition would give it more power in a growing product category.

"Value-added dairy products have been growing steadily in the United States, in contrast to the traditional fluid milk category, with great-tasting, nutrient-dense Fairlife milk products playing a significant role in that growth," the company said in a Jan. 3 statement.

M&A transactions
Select food industry deals in the past month

Date announced	Target	Buyer	Seller	Total transaction value ($M)	Status
12/17/19	Jacobs Douwe Egberts BV	Peet's Coffee & Tea Inc.	Mondelez International Inc. (Nasdaq:GD: MDLZ)	Not disclosed	Announced
12/19/19	Lender Bagel Business of Conagra Brands Inc.	Bimbo Bakeries USA Inc.	Conagra Brands Inc. (NYSE: CAG)	Not disclosed	Closed
12/19/19	Herta SAS	Casa Tarradellas SA	Nestlé SA	Not disclosed	Announced
12/30/19	Golden Island Jerky Co. Inc.	Link Snacks Inc.	Tyson Foods Inc. (NYSE: TSN)	Not disclosed	Closed
01/03/20	fairlife LLC	The Coca-Cola Co. (NYSE: KO)	Select Milk Producers Inc.	Not disclosed	Closed
01/13/20	Primo Water Corp. (Nasdaq:GM: PRMW)	Cott Corp. (TSX: BCB)	NA	786.99	Announced

Data as of Jan. 15, 2020.
NA = not applicable.
Primo Water was a stand-alone company prior to acquisition.
Total transaction value represents the prices of the deal at the time of announcement.
Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence

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DATA DISPATCH
Nearly 1,500 MW of US wind power capacity added in Q3

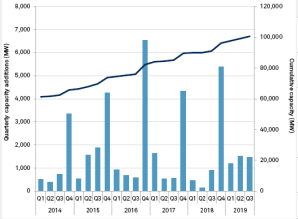
Tuesday, December 17, 2019 7:41 AM ET

By Justin Horwath
S&P Global Energy

In the first three quarters of 2019, 4,251 MW worth of wind power capacity came online in the U.S., making this one of the hottest years on record for the industry, according to S&P Global Market Intelligence data.

Developers are pushing to get projects across the line before the 2020 expiration of the federal production tax credit for wind energy projects. Six projects, totaling 1,491 MW of generation capacity, came online in the third quarter at a combined estimated cost of $2.7 billion.

US wind capacity by quarter in service



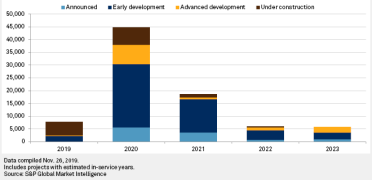
Year	Quarter	Capacity (MW)
2014	Q1	523
	Q2	380
	Q3	736
	Q4	3,366
2015	Q1	537
	Q2	1,575
	Q3	1,981
	Q4	4,293
2016	Q1	953
	Q2	761
	Q3	588
	Q4	6,561
2017	Q1	1,641
	Q2	553
	Q3	582
	Q4	4,336
2018	Q1	475
	Q2	166
	Q3	910
	Q4	5,489
2019	Q1	1,221
	Q2	1,539
	Q3	1,491

Data compiled Nov. 26, 2019.
Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence

That is the strongest third quarter for wind capacity additions since the third quarter of 2015, when 1,901 MW came online. That year, as in 2019, there was uncertainty about whether Congress would extend the tax credit.

Strong construction activity is expected to continue in 2020, with an estimated 45 GW set to be completed, according to company announcements. Some 30 GW of that total is in early development or pre-development.

US wind projects by estimated year in service, development status (MW)



Data compiled Nov. 26, 2019.
Includes projects with estimated in-service years.
Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence

Four of the six projects completed in the quarter, totaling 994 MW, were in Texas, which continues to lead the nation in installed wind capacity, according to the American Wind Energy Association. The grid operated by the Electric Reliability Council of Texas, which covers most of the state, saw all-time demand records in August, as low margins between power demand and supply forced ERCOT to call for customers to conserve energy.

The largest U.S. wind farm to come online was Innergex Renewable Energy Inc. subsidiary Alterra Power Corp.'s 350-MW Foard City Wind Project in Foard County, Texas. Vistra Energy Corp. agreed to purchase some of the output for 12 years of the project.

Invenergy LLC sold a 75% interest in the 302-MW Santa Rita East Wind Farm (Oveja) in Irion County, Texas, which came online in the third quarter, to American Electric Power Co. Inc. subsidiary AEP Renewables. Invenergy still holds a 25% stake. The wind farm holds virtual power purchase agreements with Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV for 100 MW, Merck & Co. Inc. for 60 MW and Novartis AG for 100 MW.

Largest US wind power plant projects completed in Q3'19

Plant	Project phase number	Ultimate parent	Capacity (MW)	County, state
Foard City Wind Project	1	Invenergy Renewable Energy Inc.	350	Foard, TX
Santa Rita East Wind Farm (Oveja)	1	Multi-owned	302	Irion, TX
Solomon Forks Wind Facility (Infinity)	1	Engie SA	276	Thomas, KS
Grady Wind Energy Center	1	Multi-owned	221	Curry, NM
Lockett Wind Farm	1	Multi-owned	184	Wilbarger, TX
Gopher Creek Wind Farm (Fluvanna 2)	1	GEKTERNA Holdings Real Estate Construction SA	158	Scurry, TX

Data compiled Nov. 26, 2019.
Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence

In Wilbarger County, Texas, Ørsted A/S subsidiary Lincoln Clean Energy LLC energized its 184-MW Lockett Wind Farm. The Denmark-based Ørsted now has more than 1 GW of operational assets in the U.S.

In Scurry County, Texas, Terna Energy SA, a renewable energy developer headquartered in Greece, energized its 158-MW Gopher Creek Wind Farm (Fluvanna 2).

US planned wind power plant projects announced in Q3'19

Plant	Project phase number	Ultimate parent	Capacity (MW)	Estimated construction costs ($000)*	Estimated in-service year	State
Park City Wind Offshore	1	Multi-owned	1,200	6,780,000	NA	CT
Hart Wind Project	1	Orion Renewable Energy Group LLC	150	270,000	2021	TX

Data compiled Nov. 26, 2019.
NA = not available
* Maximum estimated construction costs.
Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence

Two projects were announced during the quarter. Vineyard Wind LLC, a joint venture of Avangrid Renewables LLC and Copenhagen Infrastructure Partners K/S of Denmark, proposed its 1,200-MW Park City Wind Offshore project. On Dec. 5, Connecticut said it had selected the Park City project as part of its solicitation for offshore wind power. The state plans to draw 804 MW from the project.

Park City is the company's second major announced offshore wind project, after the proposed 800-MW Vineyard Offshore Wind Project. Federal regulators have paused the permit approval process for that project, and have not said when they will decide to deny or approve it.

Avangrid Renewables LLC is a subsidiary of Avangrid Inc., whose parent company is Iberdrola SA of Spain. The estimated construction cost for Park City is $6.78 billion, according to S&P Global Market Intelligence data.

Also, Oakland, Calif.-based Orion Renewable Energy Group announced its 150-MW Hart Wind Project in Castro County, Texas. The $270 million project is scheduled to come online in December, 2021.

Largest US planned wind projects in advanced development or under construction

Plant	Project phase number	Ultimate parent	Planned capacity (MW)	Estimated construction costs ($000)*	Estimated in-service year	County, state
Chokecherry and Sierra Madre Wind Energy Project	1-5	The Anschutz Corp.	3,000	5,400,000	2022-2026	Carbon, WY
Little Medicine Bow Wind Farm (Viridis Eolia Master Plan)	1-6	Viridis Renewable Energy Corp.	1,870	3,646,500	NA	Carbon, WY
Traverse Wind Energy Center	1	Invenergy LLC	999	1,798,200	2021	Custer, OK
Sunrise Wind Offshore Farm	1	Multi-owned	880	4,972,000	2024	NY
Vineyard Offshore Wind Project	1	Multi-owned	800	4,520,000	2022	MA
Revolution Wind Offshore	1	Multi-owned	704	3,977,600	2022	MA
Sagamore Wind Project	1	Xcel Energy Inc.	522	900,000	2020	Roosevelt, NM
TB Flats I & II Wind Project	1	Multi-owned	503	905,400	2020	Carbon, WY
Cheyenne Ridge Wind	1	Xcel Energy Inc.	500	900,000	2020	Cheyenne, CO
Goodnight Wind Energy	1	FGE Power LLC	500	900,720	2020	Armstrong, TX
Wheatridge Wind Energy Facility	1	Multi-owned	500	900,000	2022	Morrow, OR

Development status: Advanced development; Under construction

Data compiled Nov. 26, 2019.
NA = not available
* Maximum estimated construction costs.
Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence

Eleven projects, totaling 10.8 GW, are in advanced development or under construction. The estimated construction cost for those projects totals $28.8 billion, according to S&P Global Market Intelligence estimates.

Wyoming, which has fallen behind its neighbors in wind development but is now in the early stages of a surge in activity, has the most capacity in advanced development in the nation, with three projects totaling 5,373 MW.

One of those is set to be the largest onshore wind project in the nation: The $5 billion 3,000-MW Chokecherry and Sierra Madre Wind Energy Project in Carbon County, Wyo., is nearing the regulatory finish line after years of planning. Chokecherry and Sierra Madre is being developed by The Anschutz Corp. subsidiary Power Company of Wyoming.

Also in Carbon County, Viridis Renewable Energy Corp is developing the 1,870-MW Little Medicine Bow Wind Farm (Viridis Eolia Master Plan). And construction is under way on Berkshire Hathaway Energy subsidiary PacifiCorp's 503-MW TB Flats I & II Wind Project. TB Flats is scheduled to come online in 2020.

Krizka Danielle Del Rosario contributed to this article.

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THE DAILY DOSE
Nestlé expands plant-based food range; CDC flags 1 death possibly tied to vaping

Monday, August 26, 2019 7:47 AM ET

By Pratibha Alagh
Market Intelligence

TOP NEWS

* Nestlé SA has expanded its Garden Gourmet plant-based food range in Europe with the introduction of Incredible Mince, a vegan substitute for minced beef, beginning September. The Swiss food giant has also renewed the recipe for its plant-based Incredible Burger.

* The U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention identified 193 potential cases of severe lung illnesses across 22 states, including the death of an adult in Illinois, possibly linked to use of e-cigarettes or vaping devices, Reuters reported. CDC Director Robert Redfield said the agency's investigation is ongoing, adding that it is working with state and local health departments and the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to determine causes of the ongoing outbreak.

FOOD RETAIL & DISTRIBUTION

* Chinese online food delivery platform Meituan Dianping posted its first profitable quarter since its Hong Kong IPO, as the sizzling summer weather led to a surge in online orders. For the second quarter ended June 30, Meituan Dianping reported an adjusted net profit of 1.49 billion yuan, compared to an adjusted net loss of 3.21 billion yuan in the prior-year period.

* Nestlé Nespresso, Nestlé SA's coffee unit, and JD.com Inc. have expanded the espresso machine maker's doorstep-recycling program in China, enabling customers to schedule same-day or next-day pickup of their used coffee capsules through the e-commerce company's courier service.

* Suning Xiaodian, a unit of electronics retailer Suning.com Co. Ltd., acquired more than 60 Circle K convenience stores in China from Convenience Retail Asia Ltd. for an undisclosed sum, the *Nikkei Asian Review* reported. Suning Xiaodian plans to have 20,000 supermarket outlets by 2020, in a bid to expand in the southern China region, the report said.

BEVERAGES

* Anheuser-Busch Cos. LLC said it will not make a qualifying offer to purchase the remaining shares of Portland, Ore.-based beer company Craft Brew Alliance Inc., in which it has a 31.3% stake. The Anheuser-Busch InBev SA unit was expected to make the offer under an international distribution agreement that both companies entered in 2016.

* Coca-Cola Co. has completed the sale of its 354,000-square-foot 711 Fifth Ave. retail and office building in Manhattan, N.Y., to a partnership of Nightingale Properties and Wafra Capital Partners.

* S&P Global Ratings affirmed Molson Coors Brewing Co.'s BBB- issuer credit rating and A-3 commercial paper rating with stable outlook, citing its expectation for continued credit measure improvement as the company demonstrates a commitment to debt repayment and restoring debt leverage well below 4x over the next two years.

* Coca-Cola GmbH, the German subsidiary of Coca-Cola Co., named Bjorn Jensen as the new managing director of Coca-Cola Germany, Denmark and Finland, effective Oct. 1, *European Supermarket Magazine* reported. Jensen succeeds Bianca Bourbon, who has been appointed vice president of operations at Coca-Cola Asia Pacific (APAC) Group, the report said.

AGRICULTURAL PRODUCTS

* Chinese feed producer New Hope Liuhe Co. Ltd. has completed the constructions of its first overseas pig farm in Vietnam, amid rising demand for hog in the market plagued by an outbreak of African swine fever, Reuters reported. The New Hope Group Co. Ltd. subsidiary has invested 20 million yuan in the farm, which will have annual production of 300,000 pigs, the report said.

* Australian Dairy Nutritionals Group and Jonesy's Dairy Fresh have formed a 50/50 joint venture, Jonesy's Distribution Pty. Ltd., to expand their product range and increase market share. Australian Dairy Nutritionals said it will also complete the acquisition of an infant formula and nutritionals mixing plant Aug. 27.

* Indian agricultural startup LILink AgriTech Pvt. Ltd. is seeking nationwide expansion by 2022 as it raised $27 million from Bertelsmann India Investments earlier this year, the *Nikkei Asian Review* reported. The Maharashtra-based startup reportedly plans to use the funds for doubling the number of its agricultural experts to 300 and raising the number of its distribution centers to 13.

PACKAGED FOODS

* Mexican bakery chain Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV unveiled new packaging with plastic technology that uses naturally occurring microorganisms to aid the recycling process, news outlet BakeryandSnacks reported, citing CEO Daniel Servitje. The company aims to make all its packaging recyclable, biodegradable or compostable by 2025, the report said.

* S&P Global Ratings revised its outlook on The Kraft Heinz Co. to negative from stable, citing the U.S. packaged food producer's continuing performance erosion and the lack of clarity on its 2019 guidance.

RESTAURANTS

* U.K. bakery chain Greggs PLC is planning to introduce vegan alternatives for all its bestselling products after the success of its vegan sausage roll, *The Guardian* reported, citing CEO Roger Whiteside.

* TFI TAB Gida Yatirimlari AS, better known as TAB Food Investments, is considering a Hong Kong IPO of its Chinese business after dropping plans for a share sale in the U.S., Bloomberg News reported, citing sources. The Istanbul-based company, Burger King's China franchisee, is seeking a valuation of $1 billion in a listing that could come as early 2020, the sources said. "We always assess IPO possibilities. However, there's no concrete development on that front as of now," TAB Chairman Erhan Kurdoglu told Bloomberg.

INDUSTRY NEWS

* Luxembourg-based investment firm JAB Holding Co. SARL plans to raise up to $8 billion to expand its presence in the consumer sector, primarily in pet care and veterinary clinics, the *Financial Times* reported, citing sources. JAB reportedly declined to comment.

* Indian restaurant aggregators, including Zomato Media Pvt. Ltd., EazyDiner Pvt. Ltd. and Gourmet Passport, are seeing thousands of restaurants leaving their platforms due to steep discounting practices, the *Financial Times* reported. The National Restaurant Association of India started encouraging its members to boycott the platforms amid complaints that the restaurants are required to shoulder the discounts as high as 50%, the report said.

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On the macro front

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Mira Reyes, Amanda Jean Dalugdug, Soon Chen Kang contributed to this article.

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Bimbo Bakeries recalls cookies due to plastic contaminants

Friday, August 2, 2019 1:13 PM ET

By Amanda Jean Dalugdug
Market Intelligence

Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV-owned Bimbo Bakeries USA Inc. is voluntarily recalling a line of cookies due to the potential presence of visible, blue plastic pieces in the individual packaging pouch, according to an Aug. 1 release.

The recall covers five-pack packages of Entenmann's Little Bites Soft Baked Chocolate Chip Cookies with best-by dates of Aug. 31 and Sept. 7 and with UPC code 7203002378.

The products were distributed to retail outlets across 37 U.S. states, including Walmart Inc. stores.

The recall was triggered after consumers reported finding visible, blue plastic pieces on or packaged with the product.

Bimbo Bakeries noted that the plastic is not baked into the product since it was introduced during the packaging process. However, the company still warned that consumption of the plastic pieces may result in a choking hazard.

The manufacturer said no Little Bites Muffins or other Entenmann's brand products are affected in the recall.

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THE DAILY DOSE
Campbell to sell Arnott's Biscuits to KKR; Kellogg maintains FY'19 outlook

Friday, August 2, 2019 7:54 AM ET

By Pratibha Alagh
Market Intelligence

TOP NEWS

* Campbell Soup Co. signed an agreement to sell Australian cookie brand Arnott's Biscuits Ltd. and certain international operations to private equity firm KKR & Co. for $2.2 billion, confirming an earlier report. The deal, subject to customary closing conditions, is expected to close in the first half of fiscal 2020.

* Kellogg Co. reaffirmed its guidance for 2019 of an adjusted EPS decline of 10% to 11% after posting second-quarter results that beat estimates. For the quarter ended June 29, adjusted diluted EPS came in at 99 cents, down 13.2% year over year but beating the S&P Global Market Intelligence consensus normalized EPS estimate of 92 cents.

FOOD RETAIL & DISTRIBUTION

* Australian retailer Woolworths Group Ltd. broke ground on its fresh produce distribution center in a Melbourne suburb. The facility is expected to create 200 jobs during construction and 300 permanent roles when it opens in late-2020.

* British grocer Tesco PLC is downsizing its hypermarkets in Poland, with reconstruction beginning this month, *European Supermarket Magazine* reported, citing local news portal Wiadomości Handlowe. Tesco is also finalizing the sale of eight of its Polish hypermarkets, the report said.

* Arizona-based food retailer Sprouts Farmers Market Inc. said its diluted EPS for 13 weeks ended June 30 came in at 30 cents, lower than 32 cents for the equivalent 2018 period and missing the S&P Global Market Intelligence consensus normalized EPS estimate of 31 cents. Net sales rose 7% year over year to $1.42 billion from $1.32 billion.

* On-demand food delivery provider DoorDash Inc. said it will buy Square Inc.'s food delivery platform Caviar for $410 million in cash and DoorDash preferred stock.

* Amazon.com Inc. will disable its press-to-order Dash Buttons globally by the end of August, after canceling sales of the product in late February.

* Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV-owned Bimbo Bakeries USA Inc. is voluntarily recalling a line of cookies due to the potential presence of visible, blue plastic pieces in the individual packaging pouch. The products were distributed to retail outlets across 37 U.S. states.

* Aberdeen Standard Investments Ltd., one of Just Eat PLC's largest shareholders, said Amsterdam-based Takeaway.com NV's merger offer "does not reflect the intrinsic value" of the London-based online food delivery platform, *The Times* (London) reported. The investor, which owns a 5% stake in Just Eat, highlighted the British company's "reassuring" half-year results and said it should be valued above the offer price of 731 pence per share.

* Singapore-based grocery delivery startup Honestbee Pte. Ltd. has applied to start a court-supervised restructuring process as it seeks a reprieve from creditors, to whom it owes over $180 million, *The Straits Times* reported, citing a filing to the Singapore High Court. Honestbee reportedly also laid off 38 employees in Singapore.

* India's Rebel Foods Pvt. Ltd., formerly known as Faasos, has raised $125 million in a funding round led by New York-based hedge fund Coatue Management, *The Economic Times* (India) reported. Ride-hailing firm PT Go-Jek Indonesia and Goldman Sachs also participated in the latest round, the report said.

BEVERAGES

* British wine and liquor retailer Majestic Wine PLC has agreed to sell its brick-and-mortar businesses to private equity firm Fortress Investment Group LLC, for a total consideration of £95 million, confirming earlier reports. The retailer also will sell a freehold property owned by Majestic Wine Warehouses Ltd. to an independent third party for £5 million.

AGRICULTURAL PRODUCTS

* Chicago-based agribusiness Archer-Daniels-Midland Co. reported second-quarter adjusted EPS of 60 cents, a sharp decline from $1.02 in the year-ago period and missing the S&P Global Market Intelligence consensus normalized EPS estimate of 65 cents. CEO Juan Luciano said the results for the six months ended June 30 were affected by the trade conflict between the U.S. and China, as well as unfavorable weather, leading to a year-over-year decline in first-half adjusted segment operating profit to $1.29 billion from $1.64 billion.

PACKAGED FOODS

* Chinese dairy business Inner Mongolia Yili Industrial Group Co. Ltd. has completed its NZ$588 million acquisition of New Zealand-based Westland Co-operative Dairy Co. Ltd., food industry website Just Food reported, citing a regulatory filing.

* Sweet-baked-goods maker Hostess Brands Inc. agreed to sell its in-store bakery business Superior Cake Products Inc. to Sara Lee Frozen Bakery for $65 million. The deal is expected to close during the third quarter, subject to customary closing conditions.

* Brazilian meat processor JBS SA said its subsidiary Seara Alimentos SA completed the acquisition of Adelle Industria de Alimentos SA's hog processing plant in Seberi, in the state of Rio Grande do Sul.

RESTAURANTS

* Restaurant Brands International Inc., operator of Burger King, Popeye's and Tim Hortons, reported adjusted diluted EPS of 71 cents for the second quarter, compared with 66 cents in the prior-year quarter and above the S&P Global Market Intelligence consensus normalized EPS estimate of 67 cents. During three months ended June 30, systemwide sales grew 7.9% year over year, boosted by comparable sales growth in its Burger King and Popeye's fast-food chains.

* Restaurant Brands International's Burger King is expanding the rollout of its plant-based Impossible Whopper, which uses burger patties made by Impossible Foods Inc., across the U.S. beginning Aug. 8.

* Dine Brands Global Inc., operator of Applebee's restaurants, appointed Susan Collyns to its board, effective immediately. The new appointment increases the company's board size to 10 from nine directors.

Now featured on S&P Global Market Intelligence

Trump's latest trade war escalation brings tariffs direct to consumers

Yum! Brands eyes closing hundreds of Pizza Hut restaurants in US

Canadian cannabis sales continue to grow in 1st full quarter of legal sales

The day ahead

Early morning futures indicators pointed to a lower opening for the U.S. market.

In Asia, the Hang Seng dipped 2.35% to 26,918.58, and the Nikkei 225 declined 2.11% to 21,087.16.

In Europe, around midday, the FTSE 100 was down 1.69% to 7,456.63, and the Euronext 100 was down 2.42% to 1,060.63.

On the macro front

The motor vehicle sales consensus, the employment situation report, the international trade report, the consumer sentiment report, the factory orders report and the Baker-Hughes Rig Count report are due out today.

Click here to read about today's financial markets, setting out the factors driving stocks, bonds and currencies around the world ahead of the New York open.

The Daily Dose is updated as of 8 a.m. ET. Some external links may require a subscription. Links are current as of publication time, and we are not responsible if those links are unavailable later.

Mehrose Shahzad, Isa Martinez, Amanda Jean Dalugdug, Kiran Murali contributed to this article.

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AEP Renewables closes purchase of 75% stake in Texas wind farm

Wednesday, July 24, 2019 1:44 PM ET

By Saad A. Sulehri
Market Intelligence

American Electric Power Co. Inc. subsidiary AEP Renewables has completed the acquisition 75%, or 227 MW, of the Santa Rita East wind project in San Angelo, Texas, from Invenergy LLC.

Invenergy will retain the remaining 25% interest while continuing to provide operations, asset management and energy management services as part of a 20-year agreement.

The facility will sell its output to several buyers — 100 MW to Mexico-headquartered baked goods makerGrupo Bimbo SAB de CV, 100 MW to pharmaceutical company Novartis AG and 60 MW to pharmaceutical company Merck & Co. Inc. — under threeseparate virtual power purchase agreements entered in 2018.

According to S&P Global Market Intelligence data, Santa Rita East is capable of producing 300 MW of electricity.

The acquisition increases AEP's contracted renewable generation portfolio to 1,302 MW. "We've targeted approximately $2.2 billion in capital investment in our contracted renewables business by 2023, and combined with our purchase of wind, solar and battery assets in April, we have achieved nearly 70 percent of our contracted renewables investment goal," said Nicholas Akins, AEP chairman, president and CEO.

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Game over for Nintendo in China; Valmont, Tenaris face steel challenge

Thursday, July 11, 2019 9:27 AM ET

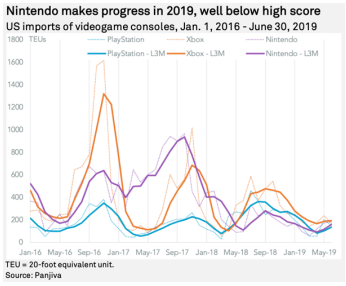
By Chris Holman Rogers
S&P Global Corporate

The Supply Chain Daily provides a curated overview of Panjiva's research and insights covering global trade policy, the logistics sector and industrial supply chains.

Game over for Nintendo in China as Switch toggles to Vietnam
Nintendo Co. Ltd. plans to shift a portion of the manufacturing of its Switch videogame console to Vietnam from China. That likely represents an acceleration of a prior plan in response to the risk of tariff increases by the U.S., though those are currently in abeyance. Console shipments have already been in decline, with total U.S. seaborne imports down 14.3% year over year in June after a 29.6% drop in the prior three months.

There is evidence of stockpiling from Nintendo — its U.S. seaborne imports surged 46.2% year over year in the second quarter — either to preempt tariffs, support the launch of the Switch Lite or to manage its production changeover. Sony Corp. and Microsoft Corp., meanwhile, have not followed suit, with imports down 47.2% and 29.5%, respectively.

(Panjiva Research - Tech, Hardware)

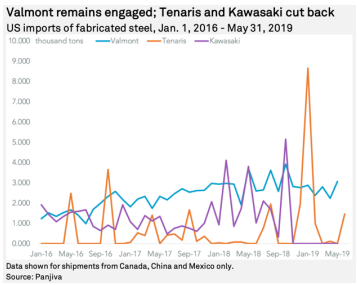


Valmont, Tenaris may be burned by structural steel case
The U.S. government has issued preliminary countervailing duties on structural steel from China and Mexico, sparing Canada. This case was filed before the relaxation of steel duties under the U.S.-Mexico-Canada Agreement and may therefore cause friction between the U.S. and Mexico.

Exports to the U.S. from Mexico have rallied 16.8% year over year in the three months to May 31, whereas Chinese exports have dropped 44.0%. The leading shipper to the U.S. in the 12 months to May 31 was Valmont Industries Inc. with 34,300 tons from Mexico, mostly by land.

In terms of seaborne shipments, Tenaris SA was the largest, with 14,400 tons from Mexico, while the largest Chinese shipper was the local unit of Japan-based Kawasaki Heavy Industries at 10,300 tons.

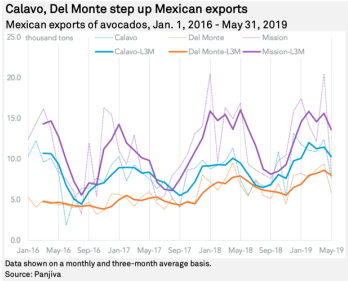
(Panjiva Research - Metals & Mining)



Calavo, Del Monte meet America's avocado hunger from Mexico
A surge in avocado prices due to a weak Californian harvest is drawing in expanded supplies to the U.S. Imports from Mexico climbed 6.5% year over year in the three months to May 31, while those from Peru and Chile surged 45.5% and 66.7% higher, respectively.

That is good news for Mexican exporters including Calavo Growers Inc. and Fresh Del Monte Produce Inc., which have increased shipments by 9.5% and a less-impressive 0.7%, respectively. Mission Produce Inc., meanwhile, saw a 15.3% drop in its Mexico-to-U.S. shipments but has increased its exports to the U.S. from Peru by 69.5% to compensate.

(Panjiva Research - Agriculture)



Taiwan tank deal great for trade deals, bad for trade negotiations
The U.S. government has approved a $2.22 billion arms sale to Taiwan including General Dynamics Corp.'s M1A2 Abrams tanks and Raytheon Co.'s Stinger missiles. That compares to total U.S. export order approvals for all countries of $32.6 billion year-to-date, up from $30.4 billion at the same time in 2018 and $19.0 billion in the same period in 2017.

Exports of weapons and military aerospace systems to Taiwan were just $402 million in the 12 months to May 31, down from a peak of $2.02 billion in the 12 months to November 2015. While helping the Trump administration's aims of boosting exports, it may jeopardize the recently restarted trade talks with China.

(Panjiva Research - Aerospace & Defense)

Asia enters export recession as Philippines inches ahead
International trade activity in the Philippines fell 3.0% year over year in May, largely due to a slump in imports of steel and oil products. Exports, meanwhile, rose 1.0%, marking a second month of better conditions, and included a 4.5% rise in semiconductor shipments.

The Philippines' improvement was not seen across Asia. Exports across 14 countries fell 2.4% year over year with the result that the region has entered a technical export recession, defined as two consecutive three-month periods of falling exports. The outlook for the U.S.-China trade war will be critical for the region given that China accounted for 42.2% of all exports in the 12 months to May 31.

(Panjiva Research - Economics)

Volkswagen Mexico accelerates while key markets slow
Mexican automotive export growth slowed in June to 1.7% year over year compared to a 4.1% expansion in the prior three months. That is in part due to declining auto sales in the U.S., which fell by 1.9% year over year, with General Motors Co.' exports down 8.0% and lower shipments by Toyota Motor Corp. and Nissan Motor Co. Ltd. too.

Not all suppliers have cut their shipments though. Ford Motor Co.'s exports grew by 23.9% in number of vehicles globally, following a 43.9% increase in dollar terms in May. Volkswagen AG has been a more extreme example; the dollar value of its exports from Mexico to the U.S. in May surged 110.7% year over year.

(Panjiva Research - Autos)

Taco Bell's flatbread shortage is Bimbo's opportunity to raise exports
Taco Bell Corp. may be facing shortages of tortillas for its signature burrito product, indicating that even simple products can face supply chain challenges. Shipments of baked goods from Mexico had been threatened with border closures and tariffs, which is significant given that the U.S. accounted for 92.0% of Mexican exports in the 12 months to May 31.

While the number of shipments from Mexico fell 1.0% year over year in May, the value of shipments climbed 6.5%, suggesting a mix of higher prices and more value-added products. The largest exporter of baked goods to the U.S. from Mexico in the past 12 months is Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV. With $315 million shipped, its shipments rose 9.7% year over year in May from 18.4% in the prior three months.

(Panjiva Research - Food & Beverages)

Christopher Rogers is a senior researcher at Panjiva, which is a business line of S&P Global Market Intelligence, a division of S&P Global Inc. This content does not constitute investment advice, and the views and opinions expressed in this piece are those of the author and do not necessarily represent the views of S&P Global Market Intelligence.

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Fitch affirms Grupo Bimbo's ratings on solid position in baked goods industry

Thursday, May 9, 2019 8:52 PM ET

By Amanda Jean Dalugdug
Market Intelligence

Fitch Ratings on May 8 affirmed the long-term foreign and local currency issuer default ratings of Grupo Bimbo SAB de CV at BBB, citing the Mexican company's position as a leading global producer of baked goods, among other reasons.

The rating agency also affirmed Grupo Bimbo's national long-term rating at AA+(mex) and kept the group's rating outlooks stable.

Fitch highlighted the company's portfolio of leading brands, extensive distribution network in key markets, and geographically diversified operations. The agency added that the rating affirmation also took into account the gradual recovery of Grupo Bimbo's leverage metrics and Fitch's expectation that adjusted gross debt-to-EBITDAR will continue to rise to about 3.0x and its adjusted net debt-to-EBITDAR to 2.9x in the next 12 to 24 months.

Grupo Bimbo operates in Mexico, the U.S., Canada, Latin America, Europe and in some markets in Asia and Africa. Fitch said the company maintained relatively stable market positions across its territories despite tight competition in the U.S., Canada and Iberia. The agency said Grupo Bimbo's competitive edge includes its position as a low-cost producer and an extensive distribution network among its main markets.

Fitch forecasts Grupo Bimbo's consolidated revenues to grow annually by about 5% in 2019 and 2020. However, the agency predicts headwinds to continue from weak private label volumes in the U.S., a tough economic environment in Argentina and challenging operations in Brazil.

The agency also expects Grupo Bimbo's EBITDA margin to be about 11% in 2019 and 2020 and for the company to pay dividends of approximately 2.1 billion Mexican pesos in 2019 and 2.2 billion pesos in 2020.

Fitch said it does not forecast positive rating actions in the short to medium term. The rating agency said it could assign a negative rating action if it sees sustained deterioration in Grupo Bimbo's revenue growth and profitability margins, negative free cash flow margin over its business cycle and significant debt-financed acquisitions.

As of May 8, US$1 was equivalent to 19.05 Mexican pesos.

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